拉莫纳 · 玩法故事

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【3.5】拉莫纳玩法 01

COL-314201

The "Mask" Wearer
戴面具的人

Sooner or later, a child's rebellious phase comes around, a little storm splitting a once harmonious family with lightning and thunder.
叛逆期或缓或急，总会降临在孩子身上，成为破坏家庭和谐的小型风暴。

And almost every storm starts the same way, with a determination to go against the mold.
风暴的起点几乎都与一次出走有关——怀抱着决心，与平日背道而驰。

With another exorcism complete, she slips away from the bustling crowd, tucks herself away in a quiet corner, and dozes off.
又一次，除灵结束后，她远离了外面熙攘的人群，独自躲进大楼的一隅，昏昏然进入梦乡。

Abandoned Building
废弃大楼内

While the exorcist avoids the people, she can't escape the growing hubbub as dawn comes. Cameras flash, journalists scribble, and interviewers stand in attendance.
除灵师躲开了人群，却躲不开自黎明始，渐次变得喧嚣的噪音——来自等候在外的闪光灯、采访和演说。

Ramona: Huh, that's weird. The exorcism's over. Why are there still people gathering outside?
拉莫纳：噢……真有意思，除灵仪式昨晚就结束了，为什么还有人围在外面？

She adopted the habits of a night-shift worker at an early age, which by now has made her a full-fledged night owl. Being woken up like this is hardly unusual for her.
她过早地养成了夜班职员才有的习惯，白天只管睡觉。但这种无端被人吵醒的情况，却也不少见。

Ramona: *yawn* I need some more shut-eye.
拉莫纳：哈——我得再补一觉……

Ramona: Hmm?
拉莫纳：嗯？

Two sets of footsteps echo down the dim hallway. At this hour, anyone coming here is either a ghost, or someone curious about the exorcist herself.
昏暗的走廊里，响起了两串脚步声。这个时间会来这里的，除了鬼魂，就只有那些对除灵师本身感兴趣的人了。

Judgmental Young Man: So this is where our "spectacular" exorcist neighbor, Ramona, did the ritual?
暴躁的少年：我们那位伟大的除灵师邻居拉莫纳，就是在这儿除灵的？

Judgmental Young Man: Figures she's a fraud. There's nothing here at all! And to think those journalists outside are calling it a miracle from some "family of exorcists"!
暴躁的少年：果然是个骗子，这儿什么痕迹都没有！外面的记者还称她展现了所谓“通灵世家”的奇迹呢！

Judgmental Young Man: Didn't you say earlier Ramona was the real deal? You still sure about that?
暴躁的少年：对了，你之前不还说，也许拉莫纳挺有本事的？现在该死心了吧？

Timid Young Man: But it's in the newspapers. So, there must be a reason.
胆怯的少年：不……但这件事上了报纸，应该有它的道理……

Judgmental Young Man: That's some dry humor you've got there. My papá says these days, the only people who make the news are the dead and those guys in masks.
暴躁的少年：你的讽刺还真高级。我爸爸说，这年头能上新闻的，除了死人，就是戴面具的家伙们。

Timid Young Man: Masks ...
胆怯的少年： 面具……

Judgmental Young Man: Metaphorically and literally. I heard during exorcisms they paint patterns on their faces to make them look like masks. Just some cheap theatrics.
暴躁的少年： 一个隐喻，也是事实。听说他们在除灵的时候，会在脸上画上花纹，就像戴上面具一样。装神弄鬼的好把戏！

The boys' voices grow closer. From the shadows, the exorcist hears every word clearly.
男孩们的声音越来越近，躲在暗处的除灵师刚好清晰地听见了这句话。

She parts her lips and quietly answers their guesses, or rather, their misunderstandings.
她张张嘴巴，小声地回应着他们的猜测，或者说，误解——

Ramona: False.
拉莫纳： 假的。

Timid Young Man: But, if it's all a scam, why would the city go to all this trouble to hire her? I heard they paid her a lot.
胆怯的少年： 如果只是骗人的，市政为什么大费周章地请她来这里除灵？听说给了她很多钱。

Judgmental Young Man: Truth is, it's all a publicity stunt orchestrated by City Hall. Gotta do something to get that investment money.
暴躁的少年： 实话告诉你吧，这都是市政用来搞噱头的手段——为了拿到投资商的钱，必须搞得声势浩大才行。

Judgmental Young Man: Hah, times are changing!
暴躁的少年： 哈，我们已经进入一个新时代了！

Ramona: Paid? First I've heard of that.
拉莫纳： 给钱？我怎么不知道这回事。

Amid the boys' chatter, a mix of irritation and betrayal pulls her thoughts back to two days earlier.
少年们还在对此事津津乐道，而她怀着一种被欺骗和戏弄的不满，将思绪拉回到两天前。

City Government Office
市政办公室

City Official: Señorita Ramona, are you saying you refuse to carry out this exorcism?
市政人员： 拉莫纳小姐，你的意思是，拒绝完成这次除灵仪式？

Ramona: You heard me. No need to ask twice.
拉莫纳： 没错，我回答得够果决了，不用二次确认。

City Official: This ritual is being held in the city's name, with even the mayor in attendance. Just think, Señorita Ramona, if this goes smoothly, you'll be a household name overnight!
市政人员： 这次的除灵仪式可是以市政的名义举行的，市长会亲自到场。想想吧，拉莫纳小姐，只要仪式顺利举行，你马上就能广为人知！

Ramona's expression remains unchanged. Clearly fame and prestige are no temptation to her.
显然，名利无法诱惑这个面色冷漠的少女。

Used to bargaining in matters like these, the official quickly assumes a reason for her refusal.
长期浸淫在名利场的大人没有过多思考，很快给对方的否决奉上了自行推测的原因。

City Official: Ah, I remember when I was your age, señorita. Back then, I too preferred to do things my own way.
市政人员： 我懂，拉莫纳小姐，我经历过你这个年纪。那个时候，我也喜欢特立独行。

City Official: If glory doesn't interest you, then picture this: after the ritual, the merchants will donate a substantial sum, and we'll finally be able to repair this building.
市政人员：既然你看不上自身的荣誉，那不妨想象一下，仪式结束后，商人们会捐赠一笔不菲的经费，我们就能把这栋大楼修好。

City Official: Whatever it becomes—a shopping center or a textile factory—it is sure to be a boost to the economy. What do you say?
市政人员：无论它变成商场还是纺织厂，都有利于我们的经济，你说呢?

Ramona: I'm just an exorcist. I don't know anything about the economy.
拉莫纳：我？我只是个除灵师，不懂得经济。

City Official: You're young. It's understandable that you don't see what businesses have done for Mexico. Just look around—railroads, public works, the power grid ... Without funding, would we have ever gotten to this point?
市政人员：你年纪小，不理解商业对墨西哥的贡献情有可原。四处看看吧，铁路、公共工程、电力网络……没有钱，我们的城市能变得这么好吗?

City Official: To be frank, we don't care who the money comes from as long as it helps us bring Mexico into the modern age!
市政人员：所以，不管出钱的人是什么身份，我们都不在乎，我们只在乎如何能让墨西哥进入现代!

Ramona: I get it. For this city to modernize, the ghosts've gotta be cleared out.
拉莫纳：好了，我知道你的意思，为了这里的城市化和现代化，必须把鬼魂赶出去。

City Official: Exactly!
市政人员：对!

Ramona: Only problem is ...
拉莫纳：可问题是……

Sensing another refusal coming, the official quickly pulls out a document.
眼见着又要遭到拒绝，市政的人马上拿出一份纸质材料。

City Official: People died there. Troublemakers. We need to make a statement. This is the exorcism contract, already signed by your parents. It's perfectly valid.
市政人员：那里死过一些人，一些不太安分的人，我们得表明态度。这是除灵的协议书，上面有你父母的签名，如假包换。

Ramona: They signed it, not me. You've got the wrong person.
拉莫纳：他们签的，又不是我签的，你找错人了。

City Official: I figured you'd say as much. But your parents left the country overnight for reasons we can't disclose.
市政人员：我就知道你会这么说，但你的父母已经连夜出国了，因为……一些不愿告知的原因。

City Official: It's already been announced that you'll perform the ritual. If you back out now, your family's reputation is finished.
市政人员：现在，由你进行除灵的消息已经放出去了，一旦毁约，你们家族的名誉可就全毁了。

Ramona's eyes grow even more weary, her defiance noticeably easing. Like accepting a school disciplinary notice, she takes the agreement.
少女眼中的神采更加黯淡，但值得庆贺的是，她的对抗情绪明显收敛了几分。像接受学校的处罚通知一样，她接过了协议书。

Ramona: Those two cowards ...
拉莫纳：那两个胆小鬼……

City Official: What was that?
市政人员：你说什么?

Ramona: Nothing. I'll be there.
拉莫纳：没什么，到时候我会来的。

Timid Young Man: Still, I heard ordinary people hire her too. To calm the spirits of dead pets and things like that.
胆怯的少年：不过，听说也有普通人找她除灵，让她帮忙安抚一下死去的宠物什么的……

Judgmental Young Man: That's bizarre! Our pets are Mexican too, you know. Their souls make their own way to the Sun, Mictlan, or Tlalocan, just like ours do when we die. But those frauds claim they're evil spirits and destroy them before they can even get there.
暴躁的少年：可笑！墨西哥人——和宠物的灵魂会主动前往太阳、米克特兰和特拉洛坎。那些骗子非说这些灵魂是坏的，是恶灵，然后把它们都杀了。

Timid Young Man: Your papá told you that?
胆怯的少年：这也是你爸爸告诉你的吗?

Judgmental Young Man: Of course. He knows everything, except how rotten those phony exorcists are.
暴躁的少年：当然，他什么都知道——除了骗子除灵师的坏心肠。

The subject of their rumors stays hidden in a corner. She shrugs them off, partly from drowsiness, partly from being used to it.
谣言的主人公此时正藏于一隅，她耸耸肩，并不介意这些闲言——因为困意，以及习以为常的心境。

Ramona: I've heard it all before. People don't know the first thing about spirits.
拉莫纳：对灵魂常见的误解，都听过几百遍了。

Judgmental Young Man: Are you shaking?
暴躁的少年：你怎么在发抖?

Timid Young Man: Um, actually, I've been hearing someone talking this whole time.
胆怯的少年：其实，从刚刚开始，我就听见有人在说话……

Ramona: Ramona suddenly perks up.
拉莫纳：听闻此话，暗处的除灵师忽然来了一点工作之外的兴致。

Judgmental Young Man: Fraidy-cat. You're just imagining it.
暴躁的少年：你太胆小，所以出现幻觉了吧。

Judgmental Young Man: Besides, there aren't any evil ghosts here!
暴躁的少年：再说了……在我们这儿，根本没有邪恶的鬼魂!

Timid Young Man: I-I'm not sure.
胆怯的少年：我、我不确定……

Ramona: **He's right. It's not his imagination. I've been watching you.**
拉莫纳：**他说的没错，不是幻觉**
我一直都看着你们

The voice from the darkness freezes them instantly. They turn to each other and scream, their panicked footsteps quickly echoing into obscurity.
黑暗中忽然响起的声音即刻终止了少年们的脚步。脑海中酝酿多时的恐惧冲出喉咙，变成两声尖叫。一串仓皇的脚步宣告了他们的逃离。

Ramona: It was just a joke. What's all the panic for?
拉莫纳：只是一个玩笑，怎么跑这么快?

New footsteps sound behind her. With a sliver of curiosity, Ramona turns.
哒哒哒——本该消失的脚步声竟然在她身后响起，这让除灵师有了一丝疑惑，但没有恐惧。

Knowing the building as well as she does, she's certain the newcomer is a living being.
以她对这栋大楼的熟悉程度，她敢肯定，来者是一个活人。

A figure slowly emerges from the dark, revealing shiny dress shoes, a flared skirt, and a girl's faintly provocative stare.
她转过头去，一个身影从黑暗中慢慢显露——崭新的皮鞋、舞裙风格的裙摆与一张略带挑衅的少女的脸。

???: So you really are here.
???: 你果然在这里。

Ramona: You know me?
拉莫纳: 你认识我?

Her flat tone carries no sarcasm, yet somehow it irritates the other girl even more than if it did.
情绪毫无起伏的询问，未带任何刻意的嘲讽，却似乎更令对方生气。

???: Don't play dumb. I go to St. Ignatius too. Renée, remember? We're classmates.
???: 用不着拿这种话羞辱我，我也是圣依纳爵学校的学生，名叫芮妮。换句话说，我们是同学。

Ramona: I remember. You spoke to me last week.
拉莫纳: 我想起来了，上周你还找我说过话。

Renée raises a brow, satisfied.
芮妮用挑眉表达了自己的满意。

Ramona: "Stay away from me, you creep. Don't ever talk to me again." Pretty sure those were the words.
拉莫纳: “离我远点，你这个阴暗的家伙，永远不要和我说话!”没记错的话，你当时是这样对我说的。

Usually the vengeful type, Renée only frowns.
芮妮用皱眉表达了自己的不满，她通常是有仇必报。

Renée: Those boys just now, they your new "friends"? That's a relief. At least you're not playing with ghosts anymore.
芮妮: 刚刚那些人是你的“新朋友”吗？谢天谢地，你不用和鬼魂一起玩儿了。

Ramona: What do you want, Renée?
拉莫纳: 这些话对我没用，芮妮，你找我有事吗?

This, in truth, is why Renée dislikes Ramona. Her solitary, indifferent nature makes the social struggles of her peers feel childish.
说到底，这才是芮妮讨厌拉莫纳的真正原因——平静、独来独往，不在乎他人的想法，让同龄人的所有追求都显得幼稚。

Renée: I want your help. Whatever the mayor's paying you, I'll match it.
芮妮: 我想让你帮我个忙，报酬的话……市长给你多少，我就给你多少。

Ramona: I'm not getting paid for this job.
拉莫纳: 很遗憾，这次的除灵工作我没有拿到钱。

Renée: What? Why?
芮妮: 我没听错吧，为什么?

Ramona: Uh, "for the modernization of Mexico," or some big ideas like that.
拉莫纳: 呃……“为了城市化和现代化”。

Renée: How can you work for free? I ought to tell Mamá; she'll be sure to have plenty to say about that!
芮妮: 你怎么能打白工？我得告诉妈妈，让她好好批判一下这件事!

Her misplaced concern makes the moment awkward.
不合时宜的好心，让气氛变得微妙起来。

Renée: Ahem, don't get the wrong idea. I'm just standing up for fairness.
芮妮：咳咳，别误会，我只是为了促进社会的公平。

Ramona: Got it.
拉莫纳：我明白，芮妮。

Ramona: Look, I don't get why you care all of a sudden, but you should be heading home for breakfast. Lights are up, which means I gotta sleep.
拉莫纳：虽然我不知道你的态度为什么突然间发生了变化，不过，这个时间你应该回去吃早餐了，而我得去补个觉。

Renée: W-Wait!
芮妮：等、等等！

But years of exorcist training have made Ramona light on her feet. She vaults the railing and vanishes without a sound, the truth behind the contract vanishing with her.
长时间的除灵训练让除灵师变得轻盈，她在昏暗中翻越栏杆，无声地消失了。同时，她也带走了除灵协议的真相。

There were no ghosts in this building. The "exorcism" was nothing more than ...
这栋大楼没有鬼魂，所谓的除灵仪式，的确是一次声势浩大的——

... a pretentious trick.
装神弄鬼。

【3.5】拉莫纳玩法 02

COL-314202

The Temptation of Happiness
幸福诱惑

Ramona's Home
拉莫纳的家

On this unusually quiet morning, Ramona sets aside her agave incense and briefly returns to ordinary life. But the letters on the table nag at her like a flock of noisy chachalacas.
难得清净的早晨，除灵师放下了龙舌兰熏香棒，短暂地回归到普通人的生活。但桌边的信件像吵人的鸟叫声般，刺激着她的神经。

Making breakfast, washing dishes, sorting clothes ... She puts off opening the envelopes with any task she can. But in the end, the bright stamp stuck to the one on top wins.
做早餐、洗餐盘、整理衣服……她尽可能拖延着，不去拆开信件。但最终，她还是折服于那亮色邮票和黑色邮戳所带来的压力。

As usual, inside is not only a letter, but a photograph.
和往常一样，除了一封信，还有一张照片。

She flips it over, revealing familiar handwriting and little doodles, tinged with the ambition and optimism she never inherited.
在照片背面，熟悉的字迹和卡通图案蹦进视野，浸染了她未能继承下来的野心和乐观天性。

Ramona: "We've arrived in Jamaica. Unlucky for us, this ghost cat proved too tricky. If only you were here, you'd have been able to lift the curse."
拉莫纳：“我们已经抵达了牙买加。可惜的是，那只鬼魂猫过于狡猾。如果你在的话，就能帮他们破除诅咒了。”

Ramona: A ghost cat? What's that?
拉莫纳：鬼魂猫，那是什么？

Ramona: Forget it. They probably just heard it somewhere. They can't even see ghosts.
拉莫纳：算了，估计又是从哪儿道听途说来的……他们根本看不见任何鬼魂。

—Which is exactly why they left right after signing the contract.
——这就是他们在签下除灵协议后一走了之的原因。

Her parents took the commission that should have been hers and trotted off to somewhere else in the world. The "exorcist family" scam continues, and the consequences fall on her once again.
她的父母拿走了本属于她的委托金继续周游世界，依靠“通灵世家”的噱头行骗。所有的麻烦则落到了她的头上。

After a moment, she opens another letter. The tidy handwriting and earnest advice seem to find a voice, murmuring in her ear.
她犹豫着展开了信，那些规整的字母和语重心长的教导瞬间有了声音，在她耳边念叨起来。

Man's Voice: "It's time you started behaving better at St. Ignatius. Stop telling your teachers there are ghosts sitting on their shoulders, and don't tell your classmates the truth about what's in the restroom."
男人的声音：“是时候端正一下你在教会学校的行为了，不要吓唬老师，说她肩膀上坐着鬼魂，也不要提醒同学厕所里究竟存在着什么。”

Ramona: But half the time I'm not even trying to scare them.
拉莫纳：但有时候我不是在吓唬他们。

Woman's Voice: "Learn to refuse requests to perform exorcisms at night. It isn't good for your health."
女人的声音：“要学会拒绝那些专门让你夜间上门除灵的委托，那对你的健康没有任何好处。”

Ramona: Most people say they're busy during the day. Even if they're scared outta their minds, they still say I gotta come after dark.
拉莫纳：大部分人都说自己白天没空，哪怕夜晚会被吓个半死，也坚持让我晚上去。

Ramona: Besides, wasn't it you who said it was money over anything?
拉莫纳：毕竟，你们也说过，赚钱更重要。

Man's Voice: "You're older now and, of course, have every right to make your own decisions. But do you really want to live this lonely life forever?"
男人的声音：“你现在长大了，有自己的想法，可你真的要一辈子过这种孤单的生活吗?”

Ramona: It is lonely, but I don't mind it.
拉莫纳：孤单……但我并不讨厌。

Man's Voice: "Others look down on you because you don't treat exorcisms as serious work. You have no friends, no home, none of the comforts of life. This is no way to live!"
男人的声音：“因为你不赞成除灵是项伟大的工作，其他人自然会低看你。你将没有朋友、舒适的房子和便捷的生活，多么凄惨啊!”

Woman's Voice: "Worst of all, mi amor, you will always be thought of as a fraud. But your father and I know how honest you are. You'd rather stay silent before a spirit than say something hurtful."
女人的声音：“最可怕的是，亲爱的，你将始终被误解为骗子。但爸爸妈妈知道，你的诚实甚至会让你在面对鬼魂时宁可保持沉默，也不愿意说出伤人的话。”

Ramona: It's not honesty. I just can't talk to them. I said it a thousand times.
拉莫纳：倒不是诚实的问题，我只是没办法和它们对话，和你们说过很多次了。

Ramona: And you don't have to hear a ghost to exorcise 'em anyway. It's about skills, not chatter.
拉莫纳：而且，除灵也不需要听见鬼魂说话，它靠的是真本事。

Woman's Voice: "Talent is destiny, mi amor. The 'spirit sight' that never awakened in us came to you like a miracle. You must treasure it and accomplish great things."
女人的声音：“亲爱的，天赋即命运，爸爸妈妈无法觉醒的‘灵视’在你身上奇迹般地出现了。你要珍惜这份恩赐，做出一番大事业。”

Ramona: Destiny ... We all die eventually. If anything is predetermined, it's death.
拉莫纳：命运……人总归有一死，要说什么是既定的命运，那就是死亡了。

Woman's Voice: "I know, I know, 'everyone dies eventually.' But you're only fifteen. You mustn't be so pessimistic!"
女人的声音：“我知道你肯定又会说什么‘人总归有一死’，你才 15 岁，不能如此消极！”

Even through the letter, they predict her answer. Blood ties.
隔着信件也被猜中了回答——血缘关系发挥了它的作用，这让她变得烦躁不安。

Ramona: ...
拉莫纳：……

Irritated, she crumples the letter—an action she's done so many times it's become second nature.
除灵师揉皱了信件，这个动作她重复过很多次，已经变成身体的本能。

Ramona: You seriously telling me I gotta lie to live a good life?
拉莫纳：难道不说谎就不能过好日子吗?

Ramona: Besides, what even counts as a "good" life?
拉莫纳：而且……到底什么样的生活才能称得上“好”?

Her frustration finds no answer. And worse, she has no one to talk it out with.
稚嫩的愤懑找不到合适的答案。更令人头疼的是，她必须独自处理好自己的坏情绪。

She looks at the sky outside and decides to go out and find somewhere quiet.
她看了看窗户外的天色，决定出门走走，找个安静的地方待会儿。

Mexico's cities are changing quickly these days. Many people have moved into new homes, leaving some ghosts without one.
如今，墨西哥的城市变得很快，许多人搬进了新住所，一些鬼魂就没了家。

Morelos District
莫雷洛斯区

For nearly a week, someone has been following her. She's known for a while who it is from the footsteps alone.
有人跟在身后——这种情况持续了近一周。多亏了灵敏的听觉，除灵师从脚步声就能判断来者的身份。

And if she doesn't deal with them now, she'll never have any peace.
如果不解决这个小尾巴，美妙的独处时光就要一去不复返了。

Ramona: I know you're there. Come out.
拉莫纳：别藏了，出来吧。

As usual, the haughty confidence of her stalker causes her to appear around the corner shiny-shoes-first.
照例是脚比头更早一步从角落里出现，跟踪者的趾高气扬暴露无遗。

Renée: You're pretty observant.
芮妮：你还挺敏锐的。

Ramona: What do you want?
拉莫纳：你究竟要做什么?

Renée: I already told you. I want your help.
芮妮：请你帮忙，我不是已经说过了吗?

Ramona: Yeah, and I said no.
拉莫纳：我以为我的拒绝意愿已经很明显了。

Renée: That's none of my concern.
芮妮：那是你的事。

The blunt reply leaves Ramona momentarily speechless. After all, conversation isn't exactly her strong suit.
如此果决的回答令不善人际的除灵师一时语塞。

Renée: Just drive the evil spirit out of my house, and I'll pay you a tidy sum. Name your price.
芮妮：如果你愿意赶走我家里的恶灵，我会给你一笔不菲的报酬，你可以开个价。

Ramona: ...
拉莫纳：……

Renée: I may have only been at school for two months, but I already know you're capable.
芮妮：虽然我刚入学两个月，但我早就听说你是个很有本事的人。

Renée: Or do you care more about reputation? I can go all around the city singing your praises if you like.
芮妮：还是说，你是那种更喜欢荣誉的人？那我可以说点好话给你听。

Renée smooths her skirt and clears her throat, as if preparing to step onto a stage.
芮妮理了理裙摆，清了清嗓子，俨然一副表演戏剧的模样。

Renée: Come on, please, Ramona! Those evil spirits are causing such a ruckus that my papá is even planning to move us out of the city!
芮妮：拜托你了，尊敬的除灵师小姐！那些恶灵破坏了我安宁的生活，导致我的爸爸打算搬离这座城市！

Renée: I simply can't leave, I can't! I've just made friends! If I leave them now, nothing but a barren, empty future awaits me!
芮妮：我不想离开这里，不想失去我好不容易得到的友情。离开这些朋友，我往后的人生也会变得黯然失色的！

Ramona: ...
拉莫纳：……

Ramona: Isn't that a bit dramatic?
拉莫纳：这是不是有点太夸张了。

Renée: Maybe for everyday life, but for a performance it's rather good, I'd say. I think I've got it to be rather convincing, don't you?
芮妮：对日常生活来说可能有些过度，但在舞台上就恰到好处了。为了能有更生动的演出效果，我练习了很久。

Ramona: That's not what I meant.
拉莫纳：我不是说这个。

Renée: Regardless, everything I said was true, especially the part about my friends. You probably wouldn't understand, ever "brave" and "independent" as you are.
芮妮：刚刚我说的话都是真的，特别是“朋友”那部分。或许你不太懂吧，毕竟你是老师夸奖过的，那种“勇敢的、独立的人”。

Memories of her upbringing catch up to her, and she feels a little embarrassed at her own sharpness. She steadies herself. This is hardly how you ask someone for help.
家庭教育的记忆迟一步抵达芮妮的脑海，她这才有些羞愧于自己的尖刻。退一万步讲，这并非求人办事的规矩。

Renée: Anyway, I really did come to you sincerely.
芮妮：总之，我是真心来找你帮忙的。

Ramona: No, I don't doubt that. It's just ... right now, people in this city are all wound up.
拉莫纳：我不是在怀疑你的真心，只不过眼下这个情况，这座城市里的人都有些……过度紧张了。

Ramona: It's probably just a wandering spirit that lost its way and ended up in your home. They usually leave after a few days.
拉莫纳：也许只是一些无足轻重的鬼魂迷了路，偶然闯进你们的家里，过不了几天，它们就自行消失了。

Ramona: I don't think we really need to destroy them all.
拉莫纳：我认为没有必要对它们……赶尽杀绝。

Her honesty earns no trust. After all, it has never been a particularly persuasive virtue.
她的诚实没有得到信任。毕竟，诚实从来不是一种值钱的品格，自然不够有说服力。

Renée: I hear your parents have been pulling all kinds of strings to try and make you into a famous exorcist. I can help too. You'd make a fortune.
芮妮：听说，你的父母到处帮你找人脉和资源，希望让你变成闻名的除灵师，我也可以帮你，让你到时候赚得盆满钵满。

Renée notices Ramona's eyes flicker and assumes she's reconsidering.
芮妮发现除灵师的眼神闪烁了一下，以为她会改变主意。

Ramona: This isn't going anywhere. Please, step aside, Renée.
拉莫纳：看来是讲不通了，那就请你让开吧，芮妮。

Renée: I don't get it. Who would refuse terms like that? Do you hate me so much?
芮妮：我不明白，为什么会有人拒绝这些条件？你就这么讨厌我？

Ramona: Nah. It's just exorcisms shouldn't come tied to worldly rewards.
拉莫纳：不，只不过，除灵这件事不应该附带太多的世俗价值。

Ramona turns to leave again. She's always been good at avoiding problems, just like when she left home after getting that letter.
除灵师再一次想离开，她很擅长逃避问题，就像她丢下那封信逃离家里一样。

Renée: Wait!
芮妮：等等！

Renée: Things at home are just awful right now. If you fix it, I'll even be your friend. I know somewhere under there you envy people like us—those of us who have someone to spend their days with.
芮妮：我家里的情况真的很糟糕，只要你帮我解决了，和你做朋友也可以。我知道的，你其实很羡慕我们这些有玩伴的人。

A spoiled teen and a reclusive loner, both unaware of the sting in their words. For adolescents, this is hardly a bad thing.
一个被宠坏的孩子，一个孤僻的独行者，她们都没意识到话语里的冒犯。对于青春期的孩子而言，这是一件好事。

Ramona turns away, letting her back give the answer.
除灵师用背影回答了芮妮。

Renée: You've not gotten rid of me! I'll be back!
芮妮：我会再来的！

In the distance, Ramona stops and turns around.
模糊的视野里，那个握着龙舌兰熏香棒的少女停下了脚步，并且转过身来。

Later, Renée will often recall this moment when the understated exorcist showed a surprising softness.
不久之后，芮妮还会想起这一幕——不起眼的除灵师在那一刻展露出的柔软令人动容。

Of course, Ramona herself doesn't think much at all about it.
当然，当事人没想那么多。

Ramona: What was that?
拉莫纳：你说什么？

Ramona: Fine. I'll deal with the spirit if you stop bothering me.
拉莫纳：好吧，我们提前说好，帮你解决了鬼魂，你就不能再来烦我了。

Renée: You mean ...
芮妮：你的意思是……

Ramona: Lead the way.
拉莫纳：带路吧。

Ramona: And quit crying, yeah? People will think I scared a classmate again.
拉莫纳：别哭了，被人看见又会以为我在吓唬同学了。

Renée: Right. This way!
芮妮：嗯……跟我来！

【3.5】拉莫纳玩法 03

COL-314203

Parrot
鹦鹉

Uptown, Mexico City
墨西哥城·住宅区

Journalist: I'm not doubting your judgment, but we've already been burned too many times by exorcists.
记者：我不是怀疑你的眼光……但在除灵这件事上，我们已经吃了很多亏。

Journalist: It would be safer to hire one we know, or have your father's associates recommend someone.
记者：找一个认识的除灵师，或者让你爸爸的合作伙伴介绍一个，要稳妥得多。

Renée: Mamá, that's precisely what you said the last time. And do you recall how that turned out?
芮妮：妈妈，你之前也说那些口碑好的除灵师很稳妥，可结果呢?

Journalist: Mi amor, those were just accidents. At least we've had three peaceful nights, haven't we?
记者：宝贝，那只是一些……意外，至少我们也度过了三个平静的夜晚，不是吗?

The exorcist at hand stands by the door, quietly listening to their argument. Her calm refusal to argue and lack of any kind of sales pitch finally draw the mother's attention.
不受信任的除灵师此时站在门边，静静地听着这对母女的低声争执。她疲于争辩的释然和绝不推销的底气终于引起了那位家长的注意。

Journalist: Alright, Renée, you've convinced me. Now, if you'd please introduce me to your, uh, classmate.
记者：好吧，芮妮，你说服我了，现在你好好介绍一下……你的同学吧。

Renée: Her name's Ramona. She handled that exorcism a few days ago—the one that both solved an urgent problem for the mayor and secured reconstruction funding.
芮妮：她叫拉莫纳，就是几天前那次除灵仪式的负责人。那次除灵仪式不仅帮市长解了燃眉之急，还拉到了重建经费。

Renée: Mamá, weren't you planning to interview her?
芮妮：妈妈，你不是还有个以她为对象的采访计划吗?

Journalist: What?
记者：什么?

The look of excited surprise on her face is nothing new to Ramona. She knows exactly what thoughts are hiding behind it—reputation, prestige, the very things hinted at in her parents' letter.
女人眼中的诧异和升腾而起的热情对除灵师而言并不陌生。她明白藏在那簇火焰背后的东西——名声、知名度，是信件所暗指之物。

Journalist: But you're just a kid. I'd expected someone older.
记者：竟然是这么小的孩子，我以为会是个上了年纪的人……

Ramona: Yeah, you and the rest. People usually think I'm some kind of legendary old shaman or something.
拉莫纳：没关系，很多人一开始都以为我是个老年人，就像传说故事里的祭司那么老。

Journalist: Sorry, this spirit has caused quite the ruckus. I had to delay our interview.
记者：抱歉，那个采访计划因为闯进家里的恶灵而耽搁了。

Journalist: But, since you're here, perhaps we could conduct it during the exorcism? I've already prepared an outline.
记者：既然你能亲自过来……不如就在除灵过程中完成采访？提纲已经拟好了。

A good journalist never wastes an opportunity.
好记者从不错过机会。

Ramona: Sorry, señora, but I have to say no.
拉莫纳：我拒绝。

Ramona: I'm here to perform an exorcism. Nothing else.
拉莫纳：我是来除灵的，不想卷进其他事。

Renée: Forget it, Mamá. She's as stubborn as a desert cactus. You'll only get pricked.
芮妮：放弃吧妈妈，她倔得和沙漠里的仙人掌一样，小心扎你几下。

Journalist: Alright. Any journalist worth their salt knows to respect boundaries. I shan't ruin the atmosphere.
记者：好吧，保持适当的边界是记者必备的素质，我们没必要把现在的好氛围搞糟。

Ramona: Can I come in now?
拉莫纳：我现在可以进去了吗?

Journalist: Of course.
记者：当然。

Living Room
客厅

The living room is bright and tidy, but books and framed paintings lie scattered across the floor, as if a scuffle happened and the owner never had time to clean up.
客厅窗明几净，但书籍和一些装饰画掉落在地上，像是发生过一次小型的打斗，而主人还没有来得及收拾好。

In the corners the light can't reach, Ramona senses something restless, something not of this world.
她能感受到，在那明亮的光线无法触及的角落，不属于此世的存在正蠢蠢欲动。

Ramona: If I'd known your house had this many guests, I wouldn't have come.
拉莫纳： 早知道你家来了这么多客人，我就不来了。

Renée: Hm? But there's nobody here.
芮妮： 没有人啊?

In a serious setting, dry humor always lands a moment late.
严肃场合内的冷幽默，总会令听者的反应慢半拍。

Renée: Aah! Where are they?
芮妮： 啊！它们在哪里?

Ramona: Relax.
拉莫纳： 别紧张。

Both mother and daughter catch the note of satisfaction in the exorcist's voice at their reaction. Strangely, they don't dislike it.
母亲和女儿都嗅到了除灵师语气里对她们反应的满意，但奇怪的是，她们并不讨厌。

In fact, it makes her seem less distant.
相反，这种“满意”让除灵师变得不那么拒人于千里之外了。

Ramona: Tell me what's been happening these past few days.
拉莫纳： 说说过去几天都发生了些什么吧。

Renée: I thought you'd know just by looking.
芮妮： 我以为你看一眼就知道恶灵是怎么捣乱的了。

Ramona: It's not that simple. Different people feel spirits differently. I need to understand how they're affecting you.
拉莫纳： 没那么神奇，而且，不同的人对鬼魂的恶作剧感知也不一样，我得先了解它们对你们的影响程度。

Journalist: Let me think. At first, book pages folded themselves into paper airplanes and flew around the house.
记者： 我想想……一开始是书页变成纸飞机在家里到处飞。

Renée: Right! At first, Mamá thought it was a surprise I'd prepared for her, until she realized they just kept flying around and around!
芮妮： 没错，妈妈一开始还以为是我给她的惊喜，直到发现那些纸飞机根本不落下！

Ramona: A surprise?
拉莫纳： 惊喜?

Journalist: Yes. Renée has some arcanist blood. Her father and I always hoped her power would awaken some day.
记者： 是的，芮妮身上有一些神秘学家的血统……我和她爸爸一直期待着她能觉醒血脉的力量。

Journalist: So, I suppose in blind hope, we were quick to misread strange things. When she scraped her knee as a child, we even encouraged her to heal it with her mind alone.
记者： 所以我们很容易被一些反常的事情误导，她小的时候摔破了膝盖，我们甚至鼓励她用念力自愈。

Journalist: Naive, isn't it? Like something out of a cartoon.
记者： 有点天真对吗？简直像卡通片里的情节。

No one notices Ramona drift off for a moment.
没有人注意到除灵师短暂的出神。

Ramona: Tell me what else has been going on.
拉莫纳：再说说其他的情况吧。

Journalist: The phonograph turns on by itself and plays music that was never recorded.
记者：留声机会自动启动，播放没有刻录过的曲子。

Journalist: Honestly, the songs are beautiful. If only they didn't play in the middle of the night.
记者：其实那些歌曲很动人，要是……它们不在半夜响起来就好了。

Ramona: All pretty typical so far.
拉莫纳：听到现在，都是些很常见的问题。

Renée: There's more! Marigolds sprout out of the floor every night. It's like it's the Day of the Dead every day in our house.
芮妮：还有呢！万寿菊会在夜晚铺满地面，搞得我们家里每天都像是在过亡灵节……

Renée: And glass jars keep shattering for no reason. We've got nowhere to store candy, flour, or cookies anymore.
芮妮：另外，家里的玻璃罐子会无缘无故碎裂，我们的糖果、面粉和饼干都没地方装了。

Ramona: Sounds like the spirits really don't like you.
拉莫纳：听上去鬼魂们的确挺讨厌你们的。

Renée: We didn't invite you here to insult us.
芮妮：……我们可不是请你上门来羞辱我们的。

Ramona: You mentioned "three peaceful nights." Could you elaborate?
拉莫纳：我记得你们说过，你们度过了“三个平静的夜晚”，这是什么意思?

Renée: These things kept happening for a month. The only quiet nights were when an exorcist stayed awake watching over us.
芮妮：这些异常反反复复持续了一个月，那三个夜晚之所以无事发生，是因为除灵师不睡觉守着我们。

Renée: Of course, she eventually left to go rest, and then everything went back to this again.
芮妮：当然，最后她被熬走了，一切又恢复原状。

Ramona: A month? That is a pretty long time.
拉莫纳：一个月？时间的确有些长了。

Ramona: Small pranks, repeated behavior, and no serious physical or mental harm. Got it.
拉莫纳：并不复杂的小恶作剧，重复的行为，也不构成对身体和精神的严重损害……我明白了 。

She raises the agave incense in her hand, the ember glowing brighter and redder.
除灵师举起了手里的龙舌兰熏香棒，从不熄灭的火星逐渐变红。

To the two clients, the laid-back air that set her apart from the city has vanished, replaced by a sharp decisiveness rare for someone her age.
在两位委托人的眼里，她身上那种与城市生活背道而驰的懒散突然不见了，取而代之的是这个年纪难以具备的果决和锐利。

Renée: Have you figured something out?
芮妮：你有头绪了?

Ramona: Maybe. What did the last exorcists say?
拉莫纳：也许吧，之前的除灵师怎么说?

Renée: Hmph, most of them said the only solution was some expensive warding tools, but none of them worked.
芮妮：咳咳，不少除灵师说，唯一的解决办法就是买足够高级的驱邪工具把它们赶走，可那些奇怪的玩意儿根本没用。

Renée: The worst was when my papá bought half a warehouse of corn kernels from a fortune-teller.
芮妮：最夸张的一次，爸爸从一个占卜师那里买了半仓库的玉米粒。

Renée: Those kernels didn't tell us anything at all! It hasn't gotten us any closer to this ghost's identity or purpose!
芮妮：这些玉米粒根本没有占出恶灵的身份和目的，而是变成了鹦鹉未来三个月的口粮！

Ramona: Can't say it isn't creative.
拉莫纳：这确实挺有创意的。

Renée: I told you exorcists were all frauds!
芮妮：可见，除灵师都是些骗子！

Journalist: Oh, I'm sure Renée didn't mean to offend you, Señorita Ramona.
记者：噢，我想芮妮没有攻击你的意思，拉莫纳小姐。

Ramona: Me? I didn't take it that way.
拉莫纳：我？我没这么想。

Journalist: Good. As you know, exorcists are quite popular these days, and many of your peers are sensitive to criticism.
记者：那我就放心了。就我所知，除灵师这一职业如今炙手可热，你的不少同行会很介意负面评价。

Journalist: Public opinion matters. Especially for someone from an "exorcist family."
记者：特别是对你这种出身于“通灵世家”的人来说，外部的舆论很重要。

The journalist pauses meaningfully, her eyes locked on Ramona.
记者意味深长地停下话语，看了一眼除灵师。

Ramona: You trying to test how I feel about this stuff, señora?
拉莫纳：女士，你是在试探我对同行和舆论的态度吗?

Journalist: My, you are perceptive. Sorry, habit of the profession.
记者：我没想到你会这么敏锐，抱歉，只是一些职业习惯。

Ramona: I'm not a parrot. I'm not gonna say what you wanna hear. Sorry.
拉莫纳：我不是鹦鹉，所以不会说你想听的话，抱歉。

The simple metaphor seems to have done its job, leaving the journalist momentarily silent.
一个简单的比喻，但又似乎具有深意，让习惯了从隐喻与寓意中挖掘真实想法的记者沉默了。

Interpreting the awkward silence as a setback, Renée starts to grow anxious.
另一颗纯粹的心将成年人的沉默理解为目的未得逞的尴尬，不免着急起来。

Renée: Mamá, you're getting off topic!
芮妮：妈妈，你偏离话题了吧！

Journalist: You're right. Let's get back to the exorcism.
记者：你说得对，让我们回到除灵这件事上吧。

Ramona: To get to the point, these spirits don't care one bit about public opinion.
拉莫纳：总之，这里的鬼魂和舆论没关系。

Ramona: And if public opinion could sway spirits, we wouldn't have so many problems.
拉莫纳：而且，如果只靠舆论就能左右鬼魂，那这里就不会发生这么多复杂的事情了。

Journalist: Hah, you're funny.
记者：呵呵，你很幽默。

Ramona: Thanks. Not a lot of people get that about me.
拉莫纳：谢谢，很少有人能理解我这一点。

Journalist: ...
记者：……

Ramona: Time to get started. If you're scared, you can wait outside.
拉莫纳：我要开始了，如果你们害怕的话，可以在门外等我。

Journalist: Let's step out, Renée, for respect's sake.
记者：那我们出去吧，芮妮，就当作我们的敬意。

Her gaze fixes on a corner of the ceiling, where several spirits drift.
除灵师的目光锁定在天花板的角落，那里漂浮着一些灵体。

The disturbances around them are violent. Not gentle ripples, but the thrashing of someone drowning.
灵体周围的波动很剧烈，不像柔和的水波，反而像溺水之人的挣扎。

Ramona: Not a usual state for a spirit to be in ...
拉莫纳：很少见的灵体状态……

She blows lightly on the agave incense. The smoke spreads, revealing the trails of the spirits to her eyes only.
除灵师对龙舌兰熏香棒吹了口气，燃烧产生的烟雾慢慢扩散，在除灵师眼中逐渐显露出清晰的轨迹——那是鬼魂的行动路线。

Ramona: They came from outside.
拉莫纳：鬼魂是从外面来的。

Ramona: Then, are they attached to this house, or seeking revenge on the residents?
拉莫纳：它们是对这栋房子有执念，还是想对主人复仇?

She lights a candle with the ember and releases her arcane energy through it, testing their reaction.
除灵师用火星点燃了蜡烛，以蜡烛为核心，释放出她的神秘学波动——她正在试探对方的态度。

The spirits only grow more agitated, even trying to snuff out the flame.
不幸的是，灵体变得更加激动，甚至试图扑灭蜡烛。

Ramona: Refusing to talk, then purification it is.
拉莫纳：拒绝沟通么……那只能进行净化了。

Ramona: I'll send you away and end the suffering of being trapped here.
拉莫纳：我会送你们离开的，结束你们被困于此的……痛苦。

【3.5】拉莫纳玩法 04

COL-314204

By the Still Lake
静止湖畔

Living Room
客厅

Renée: She opens the door, the bright sunlight dizzying her for a moment. The clients stand outside, anxious looks on their faces.
芮妮：除灵师打开了大门，外面站着焦急的委托人们，灿烂的阳光令她有一瞬间的眩晕。

Ramona: You can get a good night's rest tonight.
拉莫纳：你们今晚可以睡个好觉了。

Renée: Just tonight?
芮妮：只有今晚吗?

Renée: Or is that another one of your jokes?
芮妮：还是说，这又是你的笑话?

Ramona: Spirits are complicated. I can't promise anything long-term.
拉莫纳：鬼魂是种很复杂的存在，所以我不敢对长远的事情做出保证。

Journalist: That's enough, Renée. The girl looks exhausted. Let's not trouble her any more.
记者：好啦，芮妮，她看上去很累，我们就别拿未来的事让她烦心了。

Renée: ...
芮妮：……

Renée: Ramona, would you like to join us for some dessert?
芮妮：拉莫纳，你想进来吃些甜点吗?

Ramona: Well ...
拉莫纳：不用。

Journalist: Don't push yourself, dear. Exorcism must be tiring. She needs rest.
记者：孩子，不要勉强，除灵想必是一件很辛苦的事情，你得好好休息。

Ramona: I didn't say no.
拉莫纳：我没有推辞……

And the clients weren't just being polite, either.
但委托人也真的没有想对她客套。

The door shuts again. This time, with Ramona as a true guest.
门再次被关上了，这一次，她成了真正的客人。

Journalist: Gosh, doesn't the air feel fresher?
记者：我怎么感觉空气都变得清新起来了?

Ramona: Not really. Probably just the lingering incense.
拉莫纳：没这么夸张，可能是药草残余的香气。

Renée: Want some nut brittle?
芮妮：你想来点坚果糖吗?

Ramona: Sure. Thanks.
拉莫纳：谢谢。

Ramona: Did you just move here?
拉莫纳：你们是刚搬到这里吗?

Journalist: As expected of the mayor's chosen exorcist. You're the first to ask that question. Did the spirits tell you?
记者：不愧是市长认定的除灵师，你是第一个问这个问题的，是从恶灵那里得到的消息吗?

Ramona: No. Renée said she just started school two months ago, and I saw the housewarming cards on your table.
拉莫纳：不，芮妮说自己“刚入学两个月”，而且我看见你们桌上有别人送的搬迁贺卡。

Ramona: I can't actually hear ghosts speak.
拉莫纳：至于鬼魂，其实我听不见它们说话。

Journalist: But the papers say you can communicate with them. There's all kinds of talk of people hoping to hear from their departed through you.
记者：可报纸上说你能和它们沟通，不少人都希望从你这里得到逝去之人的讯息。

Ramona: That's 'cause most exorcists claim they can do that, so people go assuming I'm the same.
拉莫纳：这是因为……大部分除灵师都宣称自己有这种技巧，所以理所当然也以为我有。

Ramona: While we're at it, let me clarify that spirits aren't good or evil, either. They've just lost their way in the mortal world. Once their energy runs out, they fade away on their own.
拉莫纳：另外，鬼魂，或者说灵体，是不分好坏的。它们只不过是暂时迷失于现世，等到能量耗尽，自然就会消散。

Journalist: I see. Then allow me to give a proper response.
记者：好吧，那我们改个称呼。

Journalist: We bought this house two months ago. For years, Renée's father's business struggled, and we moved constantly.
记者：我们是两个月前买下这栋房子的。前些年，芮妮的爸爸生意没有起色，我们过了很长一段居无定所的日子。

Renée: Mamá, you didn't have to bring that up!
芮妮：妈妈，这个就不用提了吧！

Journalist: My dear, we must be honest about our past. You can't simply avoid it because we have a better life now.
记者：亲爱的，你得对自己的过去保持诚实的态度，总不能因为现在生活变好了就养出一身坏毛病。

Renée: That's not what I meant.
芮妮：我没有这么说……

Journalist: Señorita Ramona, I could tell the moment you arrived that Renée practically dragged you here, didn't she?
记者：拉莫纳小姐，你刚到的时候我就猜到了，是芮妮勉强你过来的吧?

Ramona: Pretty much.
拉莫纳：是这么一回事。

Journalist: Please forgive her. She just doesn't want to move again.
记者：请原谅她，她只是不想再搬家了。

Journalist: Every move means more lost friends and another difficult beginning. I imagine you understand that.
记者：搬一次，就失去一次朋友，我想你能明白这一点的。

Ramona says nothing.
除灵师没有作声。

To Renée, these words sound like a provocation. After all, it wasn't so long ago that she said the very same thing to try and hurt Ramona.
这句话在芮妮听来是一句挑衅。不久前，她就试图用这种挑衅刺痛眼前这个沉默寡言的女同学。

Renée: Mamá, why would you say that?
芮妮：妈妈，你怎么这么说话?

Journalist: Hm? Did I say something wrong?
记者：我有说错什么吗?

Ramona: No.
拉莫纳：没有。

Sensing the awkwardness, the journalist deftly changes the subject.
身为记者的母亲嗅到了谈话氛围的尴尬，她巧妙地转移了话题。

Journalist: By the way, about that card. It came from a partner of mine. The publishing house is running a call for essays about Mexico over the past decade.
记者：对了，说说那张贺卡吧。那是我的合作伙伴寄来的——出版社那边发起了一个征稿活动，希望有人能完整地谈谈墨西哥过去的十年。

Journalist: As a Mexicana myself, I have some thoughts I'd like to put to paper.
记者：作为一个墨西哥人，我有一些想法，趁这个机会，刚好能梳理清楚。

Journalist: I care deeply about this land, and I want my words to enter public discourse, but my own observations aren't enough. I need to learn more.
记者：我对这片土地很有感情，所以希望自己的话语也能进入社会舆论场域，但仅凭我自己的观察还不够，我想了解更多——

Journalist: From people like you, for example. Your silence could be a powerful entry point for an argument.
记者：例如，从拉莫纳小姐你这样的人身上。你的沉默，刚好是具备力量的论点的切口。

Ramona: No. I'm just not really a fan of small talk.
拉莫纳：不……我沉默只是因为我话少。

Renée: Mamá, stop talking about work!
芮妮：妈妈，不要再谈论工作了！

For the first time, Ramona begins to understand the source of Renée's often-irritated nature.
除灵师看了自己的同学一眼，知晓了芮妮长期保持愤懑的原因。

And at the same time, Renée begins to understand why Ramona keeps to herself.
与此同时，芮妮也明白了除灵师不喜交际的理由。

Journalist: Alright, alright, no need to get upset, Renée.
记者：好，好，你不要生气，芮妮。

Journalist: I've got some ideas I need to jot down. I'll be in my room.
记者：我刚好有一些灵感，先回房间了。

Renée: You should know, I didn't invite you just to let Mamá interrogate you.
芮妮：你应该知道，我留你做客，不是为了让我妈妈问你些什么。

Renée: You're just so famous these days, and she happens to be in a slump.
芮妮：只是你最近名气很大，她……她又刚好遇到了瓶颈。

Ramona: I know. You wouldn't think that far ahead.
拉莫纳：我知道，你想不到这么多。

Renée: ...
芮妮：……

Renée: You can be pretty cutting when you want to be, you know.
芮妮：你讽刺起人来，也挺不客气的。

The herbal scent in the air fades, and the mood cools with it.
空气里残存的药草香气正在冷却，气氛也跟着冷了下来。

Renée: I heard you live alone while your parents travel the world. Not everyone has that kind of freedom.
芮妮：我听说你长期一个人住，而你的爸爸妈妈满世界地旅行，不是每个人都拥有你这样自由的家庭。

Ramona: Freedom ...
拉莫纳：自由……

Ramona: Actually, my parents are like yours, always trying to get people in on their "profound truths."
拉莫纳：其实我爸妈也一样，喜欢让别人对那些“深刻的道理”感兴趣。

Renée: They write to you a lot, don't they?
芮妮：他们会给你写信，而且很频繁，对吗？

Ramona: How'd you know that?
拉莫纳：你怎么知道?

Ramona: Oh, right. You were following me.
拉莫纳：我想起来了，你跟踪过我。

Renée: I was not!
芮妮：不是跟踪!

Renée: Hmph, you completely ignored me at school. So I had no choice but to come to your house!
芮妮：咳咳，谁叫你在学校装看不见我？我只能上门找你了。

Ramona: Did I really?
拉莫纳：有这回事吗?

Renée: ...
芮妮：……

Renée: What do they write about?
芮妮：他们在信里都写些什么?

Renée: I'm not prying, just trying to move on to a new topic!
芮妮：我不是想窥探你的隐私，只是……想找个新的话题!

Ramona: They tell me to behave better at school and to cozy up with important people, that's about it.
拉莫纳：他们让我在学校表现好一点，还有就是尽可能多结交一些大人物……就这些。

Renée: Well, you know my mamá now, and she's a famous journalist. That ought to satisfy them.
芮妮：那你现在认识了我妈妈，她可是一个非常出名的记者，足够满足他们的要求了。

Ramona: Yeah, as long as I don't have to be the one to tell 'em.
拉莫纳：嗯，希望他们通过其他渠道知道这件事。

Renée: So they make you pursue things you're not interested in too?
芮妮：所以，他们也会强迫你做不喜欢的事?

Ramona: Make me? I guess. But they've eased up lately.
拉莫纳：强迫？算是吧，不过他们现在好多了。

Renée: How did you manage that?
芮妮：你怎么做到的?

Ramona: It only took a few attempts at running away from home. Eventually they gave up.
拉莫纳：只需要几次离家出走，他们慢慢就死心了。

Renée: That's actually a good idea.
芮妮：这的确是个好主意……

Ramona: Renée, I should go.
拉莫纳：芮妮，我想走了。

Ramona: No need to pretend we're best friends, yeah?
拉莫纳：我们没必要装成好朋友的样子，对吗?

Renée stands and glances toward her mother's study. Her sleep-deprived mind is swirling with historical events, sparing no attention for the small friendship forming in the living room.
芮妮起身，看了一眼妈妈的书房，那个睡眠不足的成年人仍在与宏大的历史作战，没有分心给客厅里正试图建立起来的微小友谊。

Renée: We're settling per job, right?
芮妮：按单结算，我没记错吧?

Ramona: Mhm.
拉莫纳：嗯。

Renée hands the envelope of payment to her.
芮妮把装在信封里的报酬递给除灵师。

They're like two children playing adults. The absurdity makes Renée laugh.
她们像是在扮演成熟的大人，很滑稽，芮妮忍不住笑了起来。

Renée: I'll see you out. It's stuffy in here anyway. I want some air.
芮妮：我送你出去吧。这里有点闷，我也想散散步。

Ramona: Alright.
拉莫纳：可以……

Ramona: But ...
拉莫纳：不过……

She studies the girl for a moment, choosing her words carefully.
除灵师观察了对面的女孩片刻，谨慎地选择了措辞。

Ramona: Renée, you seem different from how you were back in school.
拉莫纳：芮妮，你变得和之前在学校时不太一样了。

Renée: I'll take that as a compliment.
芮妮：就当你是在夸奖我了。

Uptown, Mexico City
墨西哥城，住宅区

They don't remember who first brought up the future.
她们也不记得究竟是谁首先提及未来的。

Renée: If you don't want to be a famous exorcist, after graduation, my papá can find you a job.
芮妮：如果你不想成为有名的除灵师，毕业后，我可以让爸爸给你安排一份工作。

Renée: But first you have to tell me, what do you actually want to do?
芮妮：不过，你得先告诉我，你究竟想做什么?

Ramona: If I could choose, I'd do something where I can be alone.
拉莫纳：如果可以的话，我想尽可能一个人待着。

Ramona: Maybe a gravekeeper.
拉莫纳：例如，守墓人什么的。

Renée stares at her, stunned.
芮妮有些震惊地看着她。

Renée: You really are something.
芮妮：你还真是……伟大。

Renée: A gravekeeper? To suppress evil spirits, I mean, ghosts?
芮妮：守墓人？是为了镇压恶灵——哦不，鬼魂吗?

Renée: I thought your indifference to everything but ghosts was just an act. I never thought you actually enjoyed this sort of work.
芮妮：我以为你之前那副对鬼魂以外的东西都不感兴趣的样子是装出来的，没想到你是真的喜欢做这一行。

Ramona: It's just quiet.
拉莫纳：我就是觉得那样足够安静。

Renée: What do you mean?
芮妮：什么意思?

Ramona: Ghosts don't expect things from you the way people do.
拉莫纳：鬼魂不像人类那样总是想从你这里获得什么。

Ramona: It's an honest life, one that's usually free of trouble.
拉莫纳：无人打扰，你就可以很诚实地活着。

Renée: Doesn't sound all that nice.
芮妮：听上去这不是一种好的生活。

Renée: My mamá told me about a philosopher who moved to a lakeside to escape the city, but he didn't stay for long.
芮妮：我妈妈和我讲过一个思想家的故事：他想远离城市，就搬到一处湖边生活，不过嘛——也没坚持多久。

Ramona: Yeah. Most people prefer the hustle and bustle.
拉莫纳：嗯，大部分人都喜欢热闹。

She suddenly stops walking.
除灵师忽然停下脚步。

Ramona: But when life becomes still, there's something pure there. It's like I'm weightless.
拉莫纳：不过，当生命处于静止的状态，反而能感受到纯粹的真实——那是一种轻飘飘的状态。

Renée: Really?
芮妮：是吗?

Renée: I only feel that way when I'm dancing. Though, dancing is rather exhausting too.
芮妮：我只有在练习跳舞的时候才这么想，跳舞可真够累的。

Renée: But I know what I want. I want to be a famous dancer and tour the country.
芮妮：不过我很清楚我想做什么，我想成为有名的舞蹈演员，以后能在全国巡演。

Renée: I might even send you tickets.
芮妮：到时候我可以勉为其难地给你寄票的。

Ramona: Mhmm.
拉莫纳：嗯……

She doesn't take it seriously.
除灵师没有把这件事放在心上。

She doesn't think Renée will even remember her by then.
她并不认为芮妮以后会记得自己，这只是一个出于善意的承诺。

Those with exciting, busy lives don't want to hear the same ghost stories over and over again.
在那些热闹又刺激的生活中，没有人想听千篇一律的鬼魂故事。

【3.5】拉莫纳玩法 05

COL-314205

Ghost Tricks
幽影诡计

Morelos District
莫雷洛斯区

When would a normal person actually hope they had work to do?
什么情况下，一个正常人希望自己有工作在身?

Only when something even more troublesome than work has shown up.
那必然是有比工作更麻烦的事找上门。

She holds her breath and quickens her pace, hoping to shake off her stalker.
除灵师屏住呼吸，加快脚步，希望自己能尽快摆脱跟踪者。

A task harder than any exorcism.
这可比除灵棘手多了。

Renée: Ramona!
芮妮：拉莫纳！

She pretends not to have heard.
除灵师假装自己没听见。

Renée: Ramona, stop avoiding me, would you?!
芮妮：拉莫纳，别想躲着我！

The familiar figure steps into view. Ramona stops.
熟悉的身影不讲道理地闯进视线，除灵师缴械投降。

Ramona: Am I stuck in a time loop or something? This is the fourth time you've hunted me down in the last two weeks, Renée.
拉莫纳：芮妮，这是你这半个月第四次找我了，我是陷入什么奇怪的轮回里了吗?

Ramona: You sure your family isn't hallucinating?
拉莫纳：还是说，你们一家人都出现了幻觉?

Renée: It's not an illusion or a hallucination or anything! The evil spirits are back!
芮妮：不是幻觉，那些恶灵又找上门来了！

Renée: What do they want? Are they just hell-bent on tearing flowers apart and breaking jars?
芮妮：它们究竟想要什么？还是说单纯坏心眼，就喜欢扯碎鲜花、打破玻璃罐，把我家里搞得一团糟?

Renée: Ramona, can't you try talking to them? If they have demands, we'll do whatever we can to meet them.
芮妮：拉莫纳，你能不能和它们谈谈，如果它们有什么条件，我们也会尽可能满足的。

Ramona: I told you before, didn't I? I can't talk to ghosts. I can only sense them.
拉莫纳：上次说过了，我没办法和鬼魂沟通，我只是能感受到它们的存在。

Ramona: Forget it. Something's off.
拉莫纳：算了，这件事儿的确有点邪门。

Ramona: You haven't gone and bought any more warding tools, have you? Those often have the opposite effect.
拉莫纳：你们真的没有继续买什么不熟悉的驱邪工具吗？也许正是这些工具带来了反作用。

Renée: Nope! Not a one!
芮妮：没有！

Ramona: 'Cause if what you're saying is true, it sounds like you're constantly bringing them forth.
拉莫纳：但你说的这种情况，很像是你们在不间断地主动召唤鬼魂。

Renée: What?
芮妮：什么？

Renée looks vacant. Clearly, she needs more sleep.
芮妮的神情有些恍惚，看来她急需睡眠，早起堵人并不适合她。

Renée: Mamá says if this keeps up, we'll have to move again. I don't want to lose the friends I just made.
芮妮：妈妈说，再这样下去，我们又得搬家了，我不想失去学校里刚认识的朋友……

Renée: Ramona, I know you—
芮妮：拉莫纳，我知道你——

Suddenly, two figures appear at the end of the alley.
正说着话，两个人影出现在巷子口。

Not allies, not enemies, but familiar shadows from the living world.
不是救兵，也不是敌人，是除灵师所熟悉的、现世的幽影。

Judgmental Young Man: Am I seeing things, or is that Ramona?
暴躁的少年：我没看错吧，拉莫纳?

Timid Young Man: She's not alone.
胆怯的少年：她竟然不是一个人。

Judgmental Young Man: Señorita, you're not from this neighborhood, are you?
暴躁的少年：这位小姐，你应该不是这个区的人吧?

Judgmental Young Man: Did Ramona take control of your soul and bring you here?
暴躁的少年：莫非，你是被拉莫纳控制了灵魂才被带到这里来的?

Timid Young Man: She doesn't look so good.
胆怯的少年：她看上去有些精神不济。

Judgmental Young Man: Exactly. A classic sign of possession!
暴躁的少年：这正是被控制了灵魂的表象！

Their back-and-forth chatter, mixed with the sounds of the waking city, coalesces around Renée like the commotion created by those evil spirits.
一唱一和的对答，伴随城市苏醒的声音，齐齐汇聚至芮妮耳朵里，就像是恶灵制造的动静。

But she doesn't hate the noise. Unlike Ramona, she knows enduring it is part of the life she wants to live, and she's willing to act on that.
但她并不排斥噪音，和喜欢安静的除灵师不一样，她知道忍受噪音是过上理想生活的条件之一，而她需要为此采取行动。

Renée: Tsk. So childish.
芮妮：幼稚。

She leaves Ramona's side and faces the two young men alone.
芮妮短暂放过了除灵师，独自面向一个并不友善的小团体。

Judgmental Young Man: What was that?
暴躁的少年：你说什么?

Timid Young Man: She said we're childish.
胆怯的少年：她说我们幼稚。

Judgmental Young Man: I heard her the first time!
暴躁的少年：不需要你重复！

Timid Young Man: Oh. Sorry.
胆怯的少年：哦……那我闭嘴。

Renée: You've never actually encountered an evil spirit, have you?
芮妮：你们根本没有碰到过恶灵，对吧?

Judgmental Young Man: What are you talking about? We've dealt with ghosts since we were kids. A few freaky goings-on aren't enough to spook us all the way to an exorcist's door.
暴躁的少年：开什么玩笑？我们从小就和鬼魂打交道，才不会碰到点灵异事件就吓个半死，只能把除灵师往家里请。

Renée: Really? Because the last time you ran out of that abandoned building, you looked more scared than a pair of mice running from a kitty cat.
芮妮：是吗？可你们上次从废弃大楼里落荒而逃的样子，看起来比我更害怕啊。

Judgmental Young Man: Y-You—what did you say?
暴躁的少年：你、你说什么?

Judgmental Young Man: Say something!
暴躁的少年：你也说两句啊！

Timid Young Man: You're the one who told me to be quiet.
胆怯的少年：是你让我闭嘴的……

Judgmental Young Man: ...
暴躁的少年：……

Renée: People who have really faced spirits wouldn't waste their time mocking others.
芮妮：真正碰到过恶灵的人才不会像你们一样，愿意把时间浪费在毫无意义的嘲讽上。

Renée: That's why you wouldn't understand how important exorcists are to those of us still in the land of the living!
芮妮：所以你们也不会明白，除灵师的存在，对我们这些还活着的人是多么重要！

Judgmental Young Man: Huh. And here I thought you'd say something original. But it's just the same old line from the newspapers.
暴躁的少年：我以为你会说出什么新意呢，其实，还是报纸上那一套说辞。

Judgmental Young Man: Ramona, you don't actually think she's defending you, do you? She's like the rest, just saying what you want to hear so she can use you for whatever she needs.
暴躁的少年：拉莫纳，你不会真以为她是在替你说话吧？她和那些人一样，只是利用你，让你说点他们想听的话。

Judgmental Young Man: All those evil spirit stories you made up for money, they're lies!
暴躁的少年：你为了利益编造的那些恶灵故事，都是谎言！

Ramona: I never did that.
拉莫纳：我没做过那种事。

Judgmental Young Man: Your colleagues did.
暴躁的少年：你的同行做过。

Ramona: Then go wail on them.
拉莫纳：那你们应该去找那些人。

Renée: Exactly, coward!
芮妮：没错，胆小鬼！

Judgmental Young Man: ...
暴躁的少年：……

Ramona: Let's go, Renée.
拉莫纳：我们走吧，芮妮。

Renée: Huh? Where?
芮妮：啊？去哪儿？

Ramona: Your place.
拉莫纳：你家。

Living Room
客厅

The room feels heavy as the clients wait in silence for her answer.
屋内的光线似乎凝固了，委托人们在沉默中等待着除灵师的答案。

Renée: Ramona, do you know the cause?
芮妮：拉莫纳，你知道原因了吗?

Ramona: I checked. The spirits are in the same state as before. Like the same ones came back.
拉莫纳：我检查过了，鬼魂的状态和之前极度相似，就像是上次的鬼魂又回来了。

Ramona: But the purification last time should've worked. Did I miss something?
拉莫纳：但上次的除灵应该成功了才对，难道是我忽略了什么……

Journalist: Perhaps we could try to interpret the symbolical meaning behind their behavior.
记者：或许，我们可以从象征层面来理解恶灵们的行为。

Ramona: Symbolical?
拉莫纳：象征?

Journalist: When I write, I use symbolism to assign meaning to historical choices in a way that makes them feel almost inevitable.
记者：我在写作的时候，会使用神话的象征意义为历史选择找到精神来源。这样一来，很多选择都具备了可解释的必然性。

Journalist: The paper airplanes they throw could symbolize social change...
记者：纸飞机，象征社会的革新。

Journalist: ... songs, the living, ...
记者：歌曲，象征我们这些活着的人。

Journalist: ... flowers ... I'm not sure, but perhaps returning souls.
记者：鲜花……我不太确定，但可能指的是回归的灵魂。

Journalist: The only thing still troubling me is the shattering candy jars.
记者：唯独困扰我的，是糖果罐，它一次又一次的破碎是……

Journalist: Could they represent gunshots rupturing through the past?
记者：难道指的是击穿旧日的枪声?

Ramona shakes her head.
除灵师摇摇头。

Ramona: No, señora. Some things are easier for spirits.
拉莫纳：不，女士，于鬼魂而言，很多事情没这么复杂。

Ramona: It'll only mix you up to keep interpreting things like that.
拉莫纳：像您这样推测列举下去，困扰只会越来越多。

Renée: Perhaps Papá was cursed by a business rival? Some kind of black magic?
芮妮：或许是爸爸被竞争对手诅咒了？难道他们用了什么诅咒的魔法?

A tear rolls down Renée's cheek.
芮妮啜泣起来，声音很轻。

Journalist: Don't worry, dear. Señorita Ramona will handle it.
记者：别担心，亲爱的，拉莫纳小姐会有办法的。

Journalist: Apologies. She's been unusually sensitive lately.
记者：抱歉，她最近变得有些多愁善感了。

Ramona: Sensitive?
拉莫纳：多愁善感?

Journalist: Likely just adolescence. At her age, emotions are unpredictable.
记者：我想，是青春期的原因——这个时期，孩子的心理状态总令人难以捉摸。

Journalist: She's been ever so restless, emotions all over the place.
记者：她最近有些心神不宁的，情绪起伏很大……

Adolescence? Emotions?
青春期？情绪?

The words strike her with a sudden insight, untangling the knot in her thoughts.
这几个词宛若乍现的灵光，解开了除灵师脑中纠缠不清的绳结。

She's lived alone so long that she forgot to consider emotions when dealing with spirits.
她一个人生活太久，久到忘记了在面对鬼魂时考虑“情绪”的要素。

Ramona: Señora, take Renée to the bedroom.
拉莫纳：女士，您带芮妮去卧室吧。

Ramona: I'll handle this.
拉莫纳：这里交给我。

【3.5】拉莫纳玩法 06

COL-314206

Summoning Spring
召唤春天

Living Room
客厅

The purification proceeds smoothly. The lost spirits depart once more, the corners clear, and the smoke trails settle.
除灵仪式很顺利，迷失的鬼魂再次离去，角落变得洁净，烟雾的轨迹回归正常。

Ramona: She shakes the incense stick. The ember dims, leaving only fragrance.
拉莫纳：除灵师晃了晃手里的熏香棒，火光逐渐黯淡，徒余香气在空气中萦绕。

Ramona: It's done.
拉莫纳：结束了。

Journalist: It took you longer than last time.
记者：你花了比上次更多的时间。

Ramona: Yeah. Was trying to understand why they keep coming back, but I came up with nothing.
拉莫纳：嗯，我想尽力弄清楚它们不断返回此地的原因，但没什么收获。

Journalist: Señorita Ramona, I'm confused.
记者：拉莫纳小姐，我有些困惑。

Ramona: What?
拉莫纳：什么？

Journalist: The papers say you can intimidate and control spirits through arcane skills. Some even claim you can train them if you so desire.
记者：报纸上说你可以通过神秘术震慑和操控鬼魂，甚至有人说，只要你想，就能对鬼魂进行组织化训练。

Journalist: But watching you, I see that you approach things with caution, not with the kind of power they describe.
记者：可亲眼见过我才发现，你每次都小心翼翼，并没有想象中那么……强大。

Journalist: Are the papers exaggerating, or are you hiding your strength?
记者：是报纸夸大其词，还是你故意隐藏实力？

Ramona wants to avoid the question until she catches Renée's searching gaze.
除灵师想回避这个问题，但她看到了芮妮渴望知道真相的目光。

She has never told anyone this secret.
她从未告诉别人那个难以启齿的秘密。

Because of it, she has endured troubles both internal and external.
正因为这个秘密，她不得不忍受外部的麻烦和内心的煎熬。

But she can't keep running forever. Perhaps this is the moment to begin.
但她不能永远逃走，这也许就是某种具有深意的初始时刻。

Ramona: Actually ...
拉莫纳：其实……

Ramona: Those are lies told by my parents.
拉莫纳：那只是我父母的谎言。

Ramona: I can't control spirits. All I've got is a little talent for sensing and purifying them.
拉莫纳：我无法操控鬼魂，只是觉察和净化稍具天赋。

Renée: What?
芮妮：什么？

She feels the mother's and daughter's shock, and the twinkle of excitement in the journalist's eyes. An excitement that burns.
她能明显感觉到母女俩的诧异，记者的眼中还有挖出真相的欣喜。这欣喜让她感到自己正在被灼烧。

Ramona: That's the truth of it. My parents are con artists. The "exorcist family," the "special bloodline," my fame—it's all marketing.
拉莫纳：没错，我的父母是一对江湖骗子。“通灵世家”“特殊血脉”和我的“明星身份”，都是他们用来敛财的话术。

Ramona: They played you all for fools. Some people even defend them.
拉莫纳：到目前为止，上当的人不少，但为他们说话的人更多。

Journalist: Yet you refused to cooperate with their lie. After that exorcism, many called you a fraud.
记者：可你似乎……拒绝配合他们的“谎言”。你应该知道，在那次除灵仪式结束后，有很多人说你是个骗子。

Journalist: There was no trace of purification in the building. It just looked like any other abandoned place. The crowd quickly lost interest.
记者：因为那栋大楼里没有留下除灵的痕迹，而且，它和其他废弃的场所没有区别，显得过于普通，聚集在那里的观众很快失去了兴趣。

Journalist: If there's no flash, no pizzazz, then things disappear from the public eye in an instant.
记者：而任何无法引人注目的事物，都会快速消失在公众的视野中，被人彻底遗忘。

Journalist: I heard one investor even withdrew funding.
记者：据我的内部消息，有一个投资商因此撤走了资金。

Ramona: I know. But, truth is, there were no spirits in that building. And I'm not a liar.
拉莫纳：嗯，我知道这件事。但事实上，大楼里的确没有鬼魂，我不想骗人。

Renée: You mean you intentionally left no evidence so that people would expose you?
芮妮：你是说，你故意没在那里留下除灵的痕迹，就是为了让人“揭穿”你？

Ramona: ...
拉莫纳：……

As usual, she stays silent. She never meant it as an act of noble resistance. She just followed her conscience.
一如既往，除灵师保持了沉默。她并没想过用这种堪称消极的反抗为自身增添高尚的光辉，仅想遵从内心。

Journalist: I always thought there was something profound behind your silence. I suppose it turns out the reason was simple.
记者：我一直以为你的沉默另有深意……结果，竟是这么简单的原因。

Ramona: Like I said, things really aren't that complicated in this city.
拉莫纳：嗯，我说过，在这座城市里，很多事没有那么复杂。

Ramona: And the truth can be found in things other than words.
拉莫纳：而且，真相并非仅存在于话语中。

Journalist: Interesting perspective. I should write that down.
记者：很有意思的观点，我得记下来……

Renée: No! Mamá, she never lied to us. And this is a private conversation.
芮妮：不！妈妈，她从来没骗我们，而且这是我们的私人谈话。

Journalist: Mm, alright.
记者：嗯……好。

Journalist: Forgive my eagerness. Let's go back to talking about the spirits.
记者：请你原谅我的急功近利，那让我们再谈谈鬼魂吧。

Ramona: That's what I was thinking too.
拉莫纳：这也是我所想的。

Ramona: Hey, at least you're more open-minded than I thought.
拉莫纳：但我还是想说，您比我想得开明。

Ramona: Just, please, don't go publishing our chat in the paper.
拉莫纳：我希望您不会把我们的对话写进报纸里。

Journalist: So in the eyes of a teenager, I'm not completely beyond hope after all?
记者：看来在青少年眼里，我也并不是那么无药可救，对吗？

Ramona relaxes.
除灵师放松下来。

Ramona: Like I said before, spirits aren't inherently good or evil. They're drawn back to the living world by certain things, for example—
拉莫纳：正如上次所说，灵体不分好坏，它们只是会被一些东西反复召唤至现实世界，例如——

Ramona: Family.
拉莫纳：亲人。

Renée: What do you mean? Are you saying those spirits are our ancestors?
芮妮：什么意思？难不成这里的灵体是我们的祖辈？

Journalist: But, they're not buried anywhere near here.
记者：但……他们都葬在很远的地方。

Renée: Perhaps ghosts don't follow the rules of the physical world?
芮妮：也许鬼魂能突破地域限制？

Ramona: It's not about the ghosts. It's about you, Renée.
拉莫纳：不，问题不在于灵体，而在于你，芮妮。

Renée: Two pairs of eyes turn to Renée, and she suddenly feels an inexplicable fear.
芮妮：两道目光聚焦在芮妮身上，少女忽然感受到一种莫名的恐惧。

The fear of being seized, of being erased.
被抓住、被抹除的恐惧。

A fear that is not her own, and she has to hide it.
这份恐惧不属于她，所以她必须把它藏好。

Ramona: Renée, if I've got it right, some kind of arcane power has awakened in you.
拉莫纳：芮妮，如果我没有判断错误，你近期觉醒了神秘术。

Renée: What?
芮妮：什么？

Ramona: Your arcane energy draws spirits to you. Far as I can tell, one of your ancestors belonged to an ancient "House of Song" or was an Aztec priest, maybe.
拉莫纳：你的神秘术是吸引鬼魂……据我推测，你的祖辈可能曾是古代“歌声之家”的成员，抑或是一名阿兹特克祭司。

Ramona: That's why you love to dance the Jarabe Tapatío. In older times, dance was a way to communicate with spirits and gods.
拉莫纳：这也是你喜欢帽子舞的原因——在那些古老的时光里，舞蹈本就是与鬼魂和神灵沟通的方式之一。

Renée: Ramona, you're not pulling my leg, are you?
芮妮：拉莫纳，你不会在骗我吧？

Ramona: If I'm right, there's a spirit residing within you at this very moment.
拉莫纳：如果我的想法没错，此时此刻，你的身上恐怕正寄宿着一个灵体。

Ramona: Not a common thing. Ghost stories call it possession. That's why your personality's changed.
拉莫纳：这是种很特殊的存在形式，在恐怖故事里，这种方式叫做“附身”，所以你最近才性情大变。

Renée: Stop! I'm getting goosebumps.
芮妮：别说了！我汗毛都竖起来了……

Ramona: I'm not trying to scare you. This is the first time I've seen it too.
拉莫纳：我没有想吓唬你，因为我也是第一次碰到。

Ramona: It was drawn to you and merged with your body. Revitalized, in a way, letting it completely mask its presence.
拉莫纳：它受到了你的吸引，暂时与你的肉身融为一体，这令它焕发生机，并完美隐藏了自己的能量波动。

Ramona: That's what's been calling the other spirits here again and again.
拉莫纳：就是它，一次次将其他的鬼魂召唤至此。

Ramona: Renée, those repeated destructive acts, they remind you of anything?
拉莫纳：芮妮，那些鬼魂重复的破坏行为，是否让你想起来什么？

Renée: No ...
芮妮：不……

Ramona: Or maybe I should call you "ghost," yeah?
拉莫纳：或者，称呼你为“鬼魂”更贴切？

She raises the incense stick and, for the first time, chants toward a living person.
除灵师举起了熏香棒，第一次对着活人念出了咒语。

Ramona: Ilusiones, apartaos. La verdad se revela.
拉莫纳：虚妄消却，不辩自明！

Renée: No!
芮妮：不！

Journalist: Renée!
记者：芮妮！

"She" awakens.
“她”醒了过来。

The arcanum in the host's bloodline is too weak for "her" to even see clearly.
因为寄主的神秘学血统太过微弱，“她”甚至无法拥有清晰的视野。

"She" makes out only scattered lights and two shadows, instinctively knowing they're two living people.
双眼所见，只有各色的光斑，两束阴影盖了过来，通过常识判断，这是两个活人。

Someone speaks near "her," but "she" cannot hear the words.
“她”耳边有人在说话，可听不真切。

Journalist: Renée, Renée!
记者：芮妮，芮妮！

Journalist: Thank goodness, you're awake!
记者：谢天谢地，你醒过来了！

Journalist: Señorita Ramona, wh-why isn't she saying anything?
记者：拉莫纳小姐，她……她为什么没有反应？

Ramona: It's confused. It needs guidance before it can leave.
拉莫纳：它迷路了，需要一些引导，才能离开。

A calming fragrance reaches "her," soothing the stabbing pain of her memories.
“她”闻到了沁人心脾的香气，像突刺一样躁动的记忆得到了安抚。

A hand rests on "her" forehead—dry, warm—and the burning sensation fades.
一只手掌贴在“她”的额头——干燥的、温暖的，于是“她”不再觉得自己正被灼烧。

Ramona: Este lugar, este instante. Revelado ante mí. Mostrado para mí.
拉莫纳：此地，此刻，示我，现我！

"She" hears the incantation like a ringing bell. The scent of flowers drifts in the breeze, and "she" feels the warmth of a spring afternoon.
“她”听见了咒语，像是一声铃响。
花香伴随微风钻入鼻孔，“她”感受到了春日午后的温度。

In "her" memory, "she" was sick, feverish. A doctor's white coat swayed before "her" eyes. A familiar figure entered the bedroom carrying flowers.
记忆里，“她”病了，一直在发烧，医生的白色外套在眼前晃动。
熟悉的身影踏入卧室，带来一束鲜花。

Who is that?
那是谁?

Journalist: She's shaking.
记者： 她在发抖……

Journalist: Is the evil spirit hurting her?
记者： 恶灵在伤害她吗?

Journalist: Is it attacking her soul?
记者： 恶灵是不是在攻击她的灵魂?

Ramona: No, the spirit's lingering consciousness is affecting her body.
拉莫纳： 不……是鬼魂残存的意识对她的身体造成了影响。

Ramona: Renée's reaction is so strong because ...
拉莫纳： 芮妮的反应如此剧烈，可能是因为……

Ramona: ... that fragment of awareness carries powerful emotion.
拉莫纳： 这段残存的意识附着了非常强烈的情感。

"She" feels surrounded by fragrant smoke, like a warm embrace.
“她”感觉自己被充满芳草香气的烟雾包裹，如同温暖的怀抱。

"She" remembers. The one who brought flowers was "her" father. He was always busy then, rarely able to stay by "her" side.
“她”想起来了，送花的人是爸爸，那段时间他总是很忙，无法陪在她身边。

The bouquet is set beside the bed, the crumpled wrapping making a sound like rain.
鲜花放在床头，包装纸摩擦出一阵雨声。

That long-suppressed longing tries to burst into words, but the sounds jam in her throat, and her body trembles.
压抑太久的思念想要通过话语喷薄而出，可音节像生锈的齿轮卡在喉咙，导致整个躯体开始震颤。

Journalist: What's happening?! Renée! Renée!
记者： 这到底是怎么一回事！芮妮！芮妮！

Ramona: I ... I don't know what it wants to say.
拉莫纳： 我……我不知道它究竟想说什么……

She cannot see or hear it clearly. She has no way to answer the feeling.
不可视不可听，她找不到回应这种情感的方法。

And "she," trapped in silence, cannot speak.
而“她”被封闭在这沉默的迷途中，无法倾诉。

【3.5】拉莫纳玩法 07

COL-314207

Together Forever
永远团聚

Bedroom
卧室

The smoke around Renée slowly stabilizes, at least proving the possessing spirit means no harm.
烟雾围绕着芮妮的躯体慢慢稳定下来，这至少证明，附身的灵体目前没有恶意。

Having finished her desperate phone call, the journalist pushes the door open.
记者推门而入，带着刚向电话那头求助后得到的信息。

Journalist: Any progress, Señorita Ramona?
记者：拉莫纳小姐，有什么进展吗?

Ramona: Nope. Until I know its identity, I can only calm it.
拉莫纳：在没弄清它的身份之前，我只能尽力安抚它。

Journalist: I just spoke to an exorcist I know. She said you can erase it with a purification circle.
记者：我认识的除灵师告诉我，你可以借助除灵法阵直接抹除它。

Ramona: Yeah, if it was a regular spirit.
拉莫纳：如果只是普通的鬼魂，我可以这样做。

Ramona: But this one's emotions are intense. They're already affecting Renée's mind.
拉莫纳：但它的情感波动很剧烈，已经影响到了芮妮的精神。

Ramona: Forcibly separating it from her might give her psychological trauma.
拉莫纳：贸然把它从芮妮身上剥离下来，可能会对芮妮造成心理上的创伤。

Journalist: Is there another way?
记者：你有其他的办法吗?

Ramona: There is.
拉莫纳：有。

Journalist: Then why aren't you doing it?
记者：那你为什么还在迟疑?

Ramona: ...
拉莫纳：……

Journalist: S-Sorry.
记者：抱歉。

Ramona: We need to identify it first. Then I'll guide it to the land of the dead through the ritual.
拉莫纳：我们需要先确证它的身份，再以我的除灵术作为引导，让它前往亡灵之地。

Journalist: The land of the dead? You've seen it?
记者：那是什么地方?

Ramona: Nah, not seen it. But during exorcisms, I can faintly sense it.
拉莫纳：我也没见过。但在除灵的时候，我有一种隐约的感觉。

Ramona: Spirits that remember who they are feel ... relieved when they depart.
拉莫纳：那些知晓自己身份的鬼魂，在离开现世的时候，会感到……雀跃。

Ramona: Those that forget struggle. Their pain causes way more trouble. Damage too.
拉莫纳：而那些失去身份的，会痛苦地挣扎，这种情况下，它们造成的破坏也会更厉害。

Journalist: I see. I understand your concern now.
记者： 原来如此……我明白你的担忧了。

Journalist: So, what can we do?
记者： 我们现在能做些什么?

Ramona: If you don't mind, I want it, uh, "Renée," to summon the ghosts again.
拉莫纳： 如果您不介意的话，我想让它……让“芮妮”再次召唤之前的那些鬼魂。

Ramona: I may not be able to hear them, but they can sure communicate with each other.
拉莫纳： 虽然我听不见它们的声音，但至少它们之间可以沟通。

Ramona: From the way they gather, I can figure out their relationship.
拉莫纳： 到时，我可以从它们汇合的状态推测它们的关系。

Journalist: ...
记者： ……

Journalist: Alright. I suppose I don't have much choice but to trust you.
记者： 好，我现在只能信任你了，就这样做吧。

Ramona: I'll need your help too, señora.
拉莫纳： 女士，我也需要你的帮助。

Journalist: Of course. This is about my daughter.
记者： 自然，这关乎我的女儿。

Ramona: Do you know who owned this house before you?
拉莫纳： 女士，你知道这座房子之前的主人吗?

Journalist: I can find out. I'll contact the agent who sold it to us.
记者： 我现在就去问问把房子卖给我的中间人。

Ramona looks at Renée. Her client, and now the very thing she must purify.
除灵师看向芮妮，她的委托人，如今也是她的净化对象。

Having confirmed that the possessing spirit cannot speak through this body, she knows that the limits of her ability aren't the reason for this silence.
经过此前的确认，除灵师明白附身的鬼魂没有能力通过这具躯体说话，这次无言的对峙，并非缘于她的缺陷。

Ramona: Still, I wanna know what "you" are trying to "say."
拉莫纳： 可是，我还是希望知道“你”想“说”些什么。

She crushes the incense ash and sketches a circle on the floor.
她捻起熏香棒内部的药草灰，在地板上画出一个临时的法阵。

Not for purification, but for summoning. For someone who can't hear spirits, it's risky.
法阵的目的并非净化，而是召唤，对于她这种听不见鬼魂声音的人来说，这样做是一次冒险。

Ramona: Verdad revelada, disfraces disipados.
拉莫纳： 真形，真名，勿隐，勿藏。

Outside, insects continue to chirp.
昆虫继续在窗外的草坪鸣叫。

A deep nostalgia swells inside "her," as if this ordinary day belongs to a distant past.
为什么“她”的心里有一种强烈的怀旧之情?
仿佛这寻常的一天，已是久远的事。

Ramona: The resonance is stronger.
拉莫纳： 波动增强了……

"She" cannot leave the house, not with this illness bringing "her" dizziness and nausea.
“她”无法离开这栋屋子，疾病带来了强烈的眩晕，还有恶心想吐的不适。

"She" feels lost. "She" wants to call "her" father. Like always.
“她”觉得自己迷路了，得呼唤爸爸过来，“她”一直这样做。

A patient with only enough strength to ring a bell.
一个病人，只剩下摇铃的力气。

A song suddenly echoes through the living room, mournful and familiar.
一阵歌声忽然从客厅里传来，那是除灵师熟悉的圣歌曲调，充满了哀伤。

Ramona: They're back.
拉莫纳： 回来了……

A gust of wind scatters the ash, sending Ramona stumbling back. The banished ghosts have returned.
不知方向的风卷起药草灰，令除灵师退后几步。被她多次驱赶的鬼魂正在回归尘世，踏上迷途。

Petals and paper airplanes swirl, and glass trembles like ice under too much weight.
那阵风裹挟着花瓣和纸飞机，房间里的所有玻璃发出冰裂般的声音，低声庆贺着什么。

Ramona senses the spirit floating in the ceiling corner, quietly watching. It's somewhat weaker than before.
除灵师又感受到了那个鬼魂，它漂浮在天花板的角落，静静地看着脚下的一切。和上次相比，它变得微弱了几分。

Ramona: At least it's not aggressive.
拉莫纳： 它没有攻击欲望，我该为此庆幸。

The mother rushes in with new information, this time unconcerned with the state of the room.
担忧的母亲带着新得到的消息赶过来，这一次，她不再关心房内的异样。

Journalist: I found out. The former owner was a businessman by the name of Juan López. He got in financial trouble and sold the house seven years ago.
记者： 我打听到了，房子的原主人叫胡安·洛佩斯，是一个商人。为了缓和自己的经济状况，他在七年前卖掉了这栋房子。

Journalist: My colleague from the press found an article about him. He later moved to the Morelos District.
记者： 报社的同事帮我找到了这个人相关的新闻，他最后搬去了莫雷洛斯区。

Journalist: He committed suicide five years ago.
记者： 五年前，他死于自杀，不过四十岁。

An idea flashes across her mind. There are many coincidences in this world, and it takes an exorcist to read inevitability within coincidence.
一个念头从除灵师脑中闪过——世界无时无刻不在生成偶然，对于除灵师来说，从偶然中窥见必然性是一项古老却又新鲜的技艺。

Journalist: Is he the one possessing Renée?
记者： 附在芮妮身上的，就是这个人吗?

Ramona: Nah, it's not him.
拉莫纳： 不……不是他。

The hymn carries the blessings of ancestors, wishing "her" a speedy recovery.
圣歌里蕴含了祖先们的祝愿，会保佑“她”早日康复。

"Her" spirit rides a paper airplane, leaving Mexico City—across northern plains, southern mountains, and over the ocean to the far side of the world.
“她”的意志乘坐上纸飞机，离开墨西哥城，
前往北部的草原、南部的高山，跨越重洋抵达世界的另一边。

The game of smashing candy jars that ran through "her" childhood, the flowers laid out to look like the sun every Day of the Dead ... "She" liked these things.
打碎糖果罐的游戏贯穿了孩子的童年，每一年亡灵节的鲜花都在模仿太阳……
“她”喜欢这些东西。

"She" once forgot those joys, and the forgetting made "her" weaker, so her father spared no expense bringing "her" music, flowers, and games.
“她”曾遗忘了这些快乐，而遗忘加剧了“她”的虚弱，
所以爸爸不计代价地为“她”带来音乐、鲜花和游戏。

Ramona: Señora, did Señor López have family?
拉莫纳：女士，这位洛佩斯先生，有亲人吗?

Journalist: I don't know. The coverage in the news was just a single line!
记者：新闻里没有更多的报道了，他的自杀消息就只有一行字!

Ramona: But we need more if I'm gonna crack this.
拉莫纳：但我们必须找到更多的线索。

Ramona: Don't these "pranks" feel like something parents would do to try to cheer up a kid?
拉莫纳：您有没有觉得，这些不厌其烦的“恶作剧”其实像父母哄小孩子开心的游戏?

Like the letters and photos Ramona's parents keep sending her.
就像除灵师的爸爸妈妈不断寄来的信和照片。

Journalist: What ...
记者：什么……

Ramona: If the two converging concentrations of pneuma I feel aren't fighting each other, then there's only one possibility.
拉莫纳：如果我感受到的那两股不断交汇的能量波动，并不是在自相残杀的话，那只有一种可能……

Ramona: The one attached to Renée is Señor López's child.
拉莫纳：附着在芮妮身上的是洛佩斯先生的孩子。

Ramona: She missed her father so much she called him back to the land of the living.
拉莫纳：他的孩子过分思念自己的父亲，所以才将父亲召回。

Journalist: Incredible. Señorita Ramona, why are you crying?
记者：不可思议……拉莫纳小姐，你为什么在哭?

Ramona: It's just a disturbance in the pneuma.
拉莫纳：只是受到了能量场的影响。

Ramona: The school ... Señora, with your connections, it shouldn't be hard to find a student list from seven years ago, right?
拉莫纳：学校……女士，以你的人脉，想找到七年前的学生名单应该不难吧?

Ramona: There weren't a lot of girls' schools in Mexico City then.
拉莫纳：那个时间，墨西哥城的女校并不多。

Journalist: I can do that.
记者：当然可以。

Ramona: I'll wait for your news. Find out as soon as possible, yeah? Renée can't stay like this for long.
拉莫纳：好，我等您的消息……越快越好，芮妮不能被影响太久。

The mother rushes out of the room.
一个母亲仓皇地离开了房间。

The circle on the floor is already distorted, and the forcibly summoned spirit has nearly exhausted its energy.
地上的法阵已经不成样了，被除灵师强行唤回的鬼魂几乎失去了所有的力量。

Ramona: Thank you for not hurting Renée.
拉莫纳：谢谢你没有伤害芮妮……

The girl sees "her" father turn transparent again, leaving to repay debts, compete with foreign merchants, and keep a failing business alive.
“她”发现爸爸变得越来越透明，他又要离开了，
去还借款，去和外国商人竞争，去维系奄奄一息的生意。

"She" is too young. "She" holds nothing but longing.
“她”的年纪太小，除了思念，别无他法。

No ... no ... no!
不行，不行，不行！

"She" doesn't want to stay here anymore, doesn't want to endure this loneliness!
“她”不愿独自待在这里，不愿独自忍受此世的孤寂！

Ramona: Just hang in there.
拉莫纳：再坚持一下……

She blows on the incense stick, sparks flashing as she pushes herself to keep the pneuma stable.
除灵师吹了吹熏香棒，火花闪过，她透支着自己，维持能量场的相对稳定。

Journalist: Found it!
记者：找到了！

Journalist: Her name is Bonita. She left school due to an illness.
记者：拉莫纳小姐，那个孩子叫博尼塔，因为生病退学了。

Ramona: Bonita ...
拉莫纳：博尼塔……

Ramona: That's a nice name.
拉莫纳：是个很好听的名字。

She presses her hand to Renée's forehead again.
除灵师再次将手贴在了芮妮的额头上。

Ramona: Las mentiras se desvanecen; la verdad se desvela.
拉莫纳：妄念止息，真容显露！

"She" hears another incantation. Shorter than before, but it seems to make "her" sight clearer.
“她”听见了另一道咒语，比起之前的更为短促，却令“她”的视野清晰起来。

This place is new, not "her" old room.
这里很新，并不是“她”的陈旧房间。

A strange fragrance fills the air, and a gentle, unfamiliar girl's face comes into view, a look of pity on her face.
奇妙的芬芳充盈了整个空间，一个陌生的少女温柔而怜悯地看着“她”。

Paper airplanes glide, flowers whirl, and glass shatters.
“她”看见纸飞机在翱翔，花朵在飞旋，玻璃在破碎。

They lead her memory across a bridge, welcoming "her" arrival.
它们共同牵引着记忆走过一座桥，欢迎着“她”的降临。

And in the low rushing wind, "she" remembers "her" death.
于低声呼啸的气流声中，“她”想起了自己的死亡。

Ramona: It's time to go, Bonita.
拉莫纳： 该离开了，博尼塔。

【3.5】拉莫纳玩法 08

COL-314208

A New Life for Us
你我，新生

Living Room
客厅

Another warm invitation.
又是盛情难却的邀请。

But this time the exorcist hasn't come for work.
但这一次，除灵师不为委托而来。

Journalist: We truly owe you for what you did, Señorita Ramona.
记者： 上次除灵的事，多亏了你，拉莫纳小姐。

Journalist: You really put into perspective how precious even an ordinary life is.
记者： 我从来不知道，原来普通的生活这么可贵。

Ramona: You already paid my fee. You didn't need to invite me over.
拉莫纳： 你们按时结清了委托账单，就足够了，不用特意邀请我来的。

Journalist: Haha, you haven't changed a bit.
记者： 哈哈，你还是老样子。

Journalist: Renée's fully recovered. She wanted to thank you in person.
记者： 芮妮已经完全康复了，她也想亲自对你说声谢谢。

Renée: Mamá, don't exaggerate!
芮妮： 妈妈，你不要乱说！

Her classmate has returned to her overconfident self again.
除灵师的同学恢复如初，趾高气扬——像一个派头十足的领舞。

Ramona: Still hearing ghosts in your head, Renée?
拉莫纳： 芮妮，你现在还能听见鬼魂在你脑中说话吗?

Renée: What?! Is that another one of your jokes or something?
芮妮： 又是你的幽默，对吗?

Renée: Well, don't even think about trying to scare me! An arcanist doctor my papá knows examined me. I won't be attracting any more ghosts.
芮妮： 别想吓唬我，爸爸认识的神秘学家医生来帮我做过检查，我现在已经不会吸引鬼魂了。

There isn't even a hint of uncertainty in her voice.
她的语气里没有遗憾。

Journalist: Yes, Renée is much better suited to dancing.
记者： 是啊，芮妮还是更加适合成为一个舞蹈家。

Renée: Ramona, I heard you turned down Señor Javier's request. He was offering a lot of money.
芮妮： 拉莫纳，听说你拒掉了哈维尔先生的除灵邀请，他给的钱可不是小数目。

Ramona: Yeah. Don't want the attention. Besides, I'm not the only exorcist who can purify the spirits in his place.
拉莫纳：嗯，我不想出风头。况且，其他除灵师也能净化他家里的鬼魂。

Renée: That's all very well, but if you keep hiding like this, one day everyone in Mexico City will forget you.
芮妮：好吧，你这么躲下去，总有一天，墨西哥城里的人会把你忘了的。

Ramona: Sounds perfect.
拉莫纳：那再好不过了。

Renée: You ...
芮妮：你……

Journalist: Now, now, Renée. We didn't invite Señorita Ramona here to rile her up. Give her the gift you prepared.
记者：别故意惹她生气了，芮妮，把你准备好的礼物给拉莫纳小姐吧。

Ramona: Gift?
拉莫纳：礼物?

Renée: It's not a gift! It's the payment I promised you—the rest of it, I mean.
芮妮：不是礼物！是我当时答应给你的酬劳。

A property transfer contract rests in the folder, with a key beside it.
一份房产转让协议躺在文件夹里，一旁的钥匙是赠送者的诚意。

Ramona: You've already paid me what you owed. The work I did isn't worth anything extra.
拉莫纳：该付的酬劳你们已经给了，我的工作没有这么多额外价值。

Renée: You're being stubborn.
芮妮：你的任性会害了你的。

Renée: Mamá said you collapsed from exhaustion after helping me. So, please, take it. It's yours already.
芮妮：听妈妈说，那天你帮我除灵后，累得昏了过去，所以这是你应得的。

Renée: We argued for ages about what you'd like. Finally, we settled on a remote cemetery.
芮妮：我们讨论了很久你究竟会喜欢什么……最后选择了这个偏远的墓园。

Renée: The seller looked like he'd seen a ghost when we told him we wanted it!
芮妮：卖给我们的人得知我们要买，脸上的表情像是活见鬼！

Renée: Too bad the ghost in me is gone now! Heh heh.
芮妮：哈哈，可惜我身上的鬼已经不在了！

Ramona: Nice one, Renée.
拉莫纳：很好的笑话，芮妮。

Renée: Ahem. Anyway, there'll be no one to bother you there. You can avoid your lying parents and live quietly and honestly, just as you wish.
芮妮：咳咳，我敢保证，没有人会轻易去那里，你也可以躲躲你那爱撒谎的父母，过上安静诚实的生活。

Renée: It's already decided, so just take it, alright? Otherwise I'll come to your house myself, and—
芮妮：快拿着，我已经决定把它给你了，如果你拒绝的话，我会亲自上门……

Ramona: Alright, alright. I'll accept it. Thank you, Renée.
拉莫纳：好吧，我收下。谢谢你，芮妮。

Renée: Stop that. We're not friends, you got that?
芮妮：别说这种话，搞得跟我们关系很好似的。

She takes the folder, and, with it, steps into her future.
除灵师接过了文件夹，也接过了自己未来的新生活。

Uptown, Mexico City
墨西哥城，住宅区

Journalist: Before you leave, there's something I need to tell you.
记者： 在你离开前，我还有件事要告诉你。

Ramona: What?
拉莫纳： 什么?

Journalist: I'm not going to finish writing this book.
记者： 我不会再写那本书了。

Ramona: Why?
拉莫纳： 为什么?

Journalist: It's embarrassing to admit, but when I was writing it, I focused entirely on imagery and metaphors.
记者： 说起来有些惭愧，写那本书的时候，我的注意力完全放在了外在的意象和隐喻上。

Journalist: It's as though I lost my passion for pursuing the truth.
记者： 我没有失去创作的激情，但我失去了追求真实的品格……

Journalist: I feel ashamed, really, at my insincerity.
记者： 这是一种冒犯。

Journalist: There's still much about Mexico City I don't understand, just like how you can't hear spirits.
记者： 而且，很多关于墨西哥城的事我还不明白，就像……你听不见鬼魂说话一样。

Journalist: And you were right. Once I stopped listening to the noise outside, I finally saw what was hidden underneath.
记者： 而你的想法没有错，正是因为听不见外界的喧哗，我才得以看见被隐藏的真相。

Ramona: I understand.
拉莫纳： 我明白了。

Ramona: Just don't do it with regrets, yeah? Like Renée doesn't regret losing her arcane skill.
拉莫纳： 只要您不遗憾就好，女士，就像芮妮不遗憾于失去她的神秘术。

Journalist: You're right. I have a lot to learn from you and Renée about being at peace with myself.
记者： 你说得对，小姐，在自洽这件事上，我得向你和芮妮学习。

Journalist: Adiós.
记者： 再见。

Ramona: Adiós, señora.
拉莫纳： 再见，女士。

Cemetery
荒郊墓地

On yet another Day of the Dead, Ramona arrives at her future home with candles and flowers in hand.
又是一年亡灵节，除灵师带着蜡烛和鲜花前往自己未来的新家。

She is making preparations to move in soon.
她要来这里做些准备，以便不久后搬进来。

The names and epitaphs on the tombstones are worn by time but still readable.
墓碑上的人名和墓志铭因时间和风沙的磨损而变得模糊，好在，它们没有彻底丧失被读出来的可能。

The spirits drifting here have long been forgotten, unable to pass on.
飘荡在这里的鬼魂早已被人忘却，无法前往来世。

But it's not too late. Some still remain, not yet lost to pain and despair.
她来得不算晚，一部分鬼魂仍在此飘荡，没有在痛苦和无助中走向彻底的消亡。

She arranges the candles and flowers, setting up a small altar.
除灵师摆好蜡烛和鲜花，在墓园里搭建了一座小小的祭台。

Ramona: I'll remember you.
拉莫纳：我会记住你们的。

Ramona: And Señor López, and Bonita.
拉莫纳：还有洛佩斯先生，以及……博尼塔。

Ramona: You'll return to this world again, with new lives.
拉莫纳：你们还会回到这个世界，以新生命的形式。

With her preparations complete, she begins guiding the souls onward.
除灵师做好了准备，开始引导亡灵们。

Ramona: ¡Abraza la luz... hacia las tierras más allá de la muerte!
拉莫纳：此处，彼处，往世，来世！

The flames flare in an instant, and petals lift into the wind, rising toward the night's sky.
霎时间，火光受到神秘术的影响而变亮，花瓣在风中飞舞，直往漆黑的夜空而去。

Her rebellious phase came early, forcing her to face the questions of who she was and what kind of life she wanted.
她的叛逆期来得很早，无法避免地提前思考何为自我，以及自己究竟想过什么样的生活。

During the long period of solitude, she neither retreated to a lonely lakeside like a philosopher nor immersed herself in a bustling city like a performer.
漫长的孤寂里，她没有像思想家一样前往无人的湖畔，也没有像表演家一样沉浸于富饶的城市。

She simply drifted, like a ghost.
她悬浮着，如同一缕鬼魂。

But in the end, she made her choice.
还好，她最终做出了选择。

Ramona: You either live among the living, or live among the dead.
拉莫纳：要么和活人生活在一起，要么……和鬼魂生活在一起。

Ramona: From now on, this is my "good life."
拉莫纳：从现在开始，这就是我的好生活了。

An officer in a black uniform arrives to inspect the Vigiles Bureau's new contractor. Unfortunately for her, there isn't even a spare chair for her to sit in yet.
身着黑色制服的执夜人长官前来考察夜巡特遣管理局新的合作者。她运气不好，合作者刚住进这里，甚至没有一把多余的椅子。

Black Ibis: I ought to bring you a housewarming gift, Ms. Ramona. Say a chair and table?
黑鹮：拉莫纳小姐，需要我给你送点乔迁贺礼吗？例如桌子椅子什么的？

Ramona: Thanks, but no thanks. I only just left the clutter of my "psychic family." I'm good without any more stuff.
拉莫纳：谢谢您的好心，但不需要了。严格来说，我只是离开了“通灵世家”的屋檐，回到了我待得舒服的地方。

Ramona: Think of it as running away from home. But indefinitely.
拉莫纳：黑鹳女士，您可以把它理解为一次离家出走，无限期的那种。

She calmly continues organizing her few belongings. The officer, quickly giving up on inviting her to the office, leans on the doorway instead.
合作者继续坦然地整理自己本就不多的物品，执夜人长官放弃了邀请对方去局里坐坐的想法，索性倚在门边问问题。

Black Ibis: Alright, let's get to the point.
黑鹳：行，那让我们进入正题吧。

Black Ibis: Ms. Ramona, you've handled a great deal of arcane disturbances with impressive results.
黑鹳：拉莫纳小姐，在净化神秘学波动这件事上，你称得上是经验颇丰，硕果累累。

Black Ibis: In fact, I hear that even the most influential figures in Mexico City come to you in hopes of uncovering the secrets of the night.
黑鹳：听说，连墨西哥城里有头有脸的大人物都希望从你这里得到隐藏在夜色之下的秘密。

Black Ibis: With skills like that, there was no need to list your "defect" in your file.
黑鹳：有如此过硬的专业本领，你没有必要在入职档案里专门备注上自己的“缺陷”。

Ramona: I was just being honest, boss.
拉莫纳：我只是比较诚实，长官。

She pauses and looks seriously at her superior.
听闻此话，除灵师忽然停下了手里的动作，认真地看向自己年轻的上司。

Ramona: Do the Vigiles have a problem with the fact that I can't hear spirits talk?
拉莫纳：黑鹳女士，是夜巡特遣介意我听不见鬼魂说话这件事吗?

Ramona: Are you trying to fire me?
拉莫纳：您这次来考察，难不成是想开除我?

Black Ibis: Oh, nothing like that. This is just a follow-up visit. I'm new to the branch, so I need to understand my future partners.
黑鹳：别误会，我是来做入职回访的，毕竟我也刚到分部，总得了解一下未来合作伙伴们的个性。

Ramona studies her superior for a moment. Satisfied, she resolves to trust her.
除灵师打量了一下对方，选择了信任。

Ramona: Actually, I don't think of it as a defect.
拉莫纳：其实，我不觉得备注里的内容是缺陷。

Ramona: Different exorcists have different methods. For me, not hearing spirits is an advantage.
拉莫纳：不同的除灵师有不同的技巧，对我而言，无法听见鬼魂说话反而是一件好事。

Ramona: Just like the living, the dead lie too. I've heard of many exorcists being misled by what spirits say.
拉莫纳：活着的人会撒谎，死去的人也会——我听说不少同行被鬼魂的话耍得团团转。

Ramona: But living or dead, the traces they leave behind always lean toward truth.
拉莫纳：可无论是活着的人还是死去的人，他们留下的痕迹是完全趋向真实的。

Ramona: And with that, I can uncover those fabricated secrets and truths buried by time.
拉莫纳：借此，我能揭开那些被伪造过的秘密，以及被时间淹没的真相。

Black Ibis: Impressive. It's no wonder the city's elites want to meet you.
黑鹳：哇噢，异于常人的觉悟，不愧是大人物们要争着见一面的除灵师。

Black Ibis: Your skills are exactly what the Vigiles need.
黑鹳：你的这种能力，很明显是夜巡特遣所需要的。

She closes her folder, signaling the end of the inspection.
执夜人长官合上了手里的文件夹，宣告了此次考察结束。

Ramona: That's it?
拉莫纳：这就结束了？

Black Ibis: You've made yourself perfectly clear. No need for me to pretend to take notes.
黑鹮：你说得很清楚，我也没必要装模作样地写笔记了。

Ramona: Wait, boss. I have a request.
拉莫纳：请等一下，黑鹮女士，我有一个请求。

Black Ibis: I'm listening.
黑鹮：洗耳恭听。

Ramona: I'd like to keep some secrets of my own, if you don't mind.
拉莫纳：如果可以的话，我也希望拥有属于自己的秘密。

Ramona: So if you send people to find me, they gotta go through some steps first. Exorcist stuff.
拉莫纳：以后您要是派人来这里找我，我希望他们能够遵守一些除灵师的规则。

Black Ibis: What steps?
黑鹮：什么规则？

Ramona: Two steps. First, spin around ten times with your arm out like an elephant's trunk. Then, whistle the tune of *La Llorona*. I'll come out.
拉莫纳：只需两个步骤——来者做完“大象鼻子转圈”后，再用口哨吹出《哭泣的女神秘学家》的曲调，我就会出现了。

Black Ibis: Is there some deeper meaning to that? I mean, in exorcism terms.
黑鹮：有什么深意吗？我是指，在除灵的领域里。

Ramona: No. I just made it up.
拉莫纳：没有，是我临时想到的。

Black Ibis: So you don't want to be disturbed.
黑鹮：你是在暗示我，你不想被人打扰。

Black Ibis: Haha, understood.
黑鹮：哈哈，我理解了。

As they talk, Ramona gathers a thick stack of letters and tosses them straight into the fire.
正说着话，除灵师整理出一摞厚厚的信件，径直往火堆里丢。

Black Ibis: Letters from a friend? Had a falling out?
黑鹮：是你朋友寄的信？你们绝交了？

Ramona: Friend? They're from my parents.
拉莫纳：朋友？其实是我父母。

Black Ibis: Your parents? I see. Then, I'll treat this as another one of your secrets.
黑鹮：父母？我倒是听说过……要是你不想多说，那我就当这也是你的秘密了。

Ramona: Appreciate it, boss.
拉莫纳：谢谢您，长官。

Ramona: If it's not too much trouble for you, I'll just use the Bureau's address from now on. The mailman can deliver them there. I won't read them anyway.
拉莫纳：如果您不嫌麻烦，以后我可以填夜巡特遣管理局的地址，让邮差把信送到您那边，反正我也不看。

Black Ibis: Sure. Once you officially join, you'll have a desk and a mailbox.
黑鹮：可以啊，只要你正式加入夜巡特遣，我们就会给你准备工位和信箱的。

Ramona: That's the real reason you came here today, isn't it?
拉莫纳：长官，这才是您今天的目的，对吗?

Black Ibis: You got me. Wouldn't want to miss out on new talent.
黑鹮：嗯，我们不想错失人才。

Ramona: I don't like the idea of being a Vigil.
拉莫纳：关于成为执夜人这件事，请允许我拒绝。

Ramona: A contractor's life is just right for me. Low commitment. Besides, I've never been good at dealing with beings that talk.
拉莫纳：我只想当一个钱少事少的协作者，而且，我从来不擅长和会说话的存在打交道。

Black Ibis: Fair enough. The Bureau can develop a partnership model as well.
黑鹮：好吧，不算意外，夜巡特遣也可以趁此发展一下协作模式。

Ramona: Thanks for understanding, boss. I gotta go. There's a job waiting.
拉莫纳：感谢您的理解，长官，现在我要走了，有一个委托等着我。

Black Ibis: Adiós, Ramona.
黑鹮：再见，拉莫纳。

Ramona: Adiós, boss.
拉莫纳：再见，长官。